

INBRIEF



Chettinad Group donates ₹3 crore to CM's Relief Fund

The Chettinad Group has donated ₹3 crore to the Chief Minister's Relief Fund. Chettinad Group managing director M.A.M.R. Muthiah called on Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the Secretariat in Chennai on Monday and handed over a cheque for ₹3 crore to him.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (July 7, Tuesday), the following articles are available:

■ How El Niño could damage India's economy newsth.live/elninoimpact

■ Why FDA approval for vepdegrastrant is a major shift in cancer therapy newsth.live/cancertherapy

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Corpn. defers new infrastructure projects, cancels tenders worth more than ₹600 cr.

An official says the tender cancellations have been implemented mainly to stagger expenditure and improve planning. The civic body has also not released the annual ward maintenance funds for civic repairs and sanitation, leaving many buildings, including UPHCs, in a damaged state

CITY MATTERS

R. Aishwaryaa
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has deferred several new infrastructure projects, cancelled tenders worth over ₹600 crore, and stepped up its property tax collection drive, as it seeks to ease financial pressure arising from pending bill payments of about ₹2,000 crore.

GCC Standing Committee (Taxation and Finance) Chairperson Sarbajaya Das said no new tenders for large-scale projects were being floated currently. "Only projects already under way, including those under the Vada Chennai Valarchi Thittam, are continuing. Many new projects



Fund crunch: A senior official in the GCC's Bus Route Roads Department says several tenders for road and footpath works have been cancelled mainly due to a sharp increase in bitumen price. FILE PHOTO

have been stalled," she said.

Further, the annual ward maintenance funds, which were reduced from ₹10 lakh to ₹5 lakh per ward in recent years, for civic repairs and sanitation, have also not been released by the civic body. So, many damaged build-

ings, such as urban primary health centres (UPHCs), are yet to be repaired, Ms. Das said.

A senior GCC official told *The Hindu*: "Tenders worth around ₹600 crore- ₹700 crore, including the proposed Velachery bridge project, had been cancelled, mainly to stagger

expenditure and improve planning. Some limited tenders were cancelled because they were floated with only a 24-hour notice period, which is a procedural violation."

In addition, capital-intensive projects will be re-tendered after cash flow improves, he said. Howev-

er, revenue-generating projects, such as pedestrian plaza improvements and multi-level car parks, will continue, as will grant-backed schemes, he clarified. The GCC faces a ₹2,000-crore backlog in bills, hence these measures were taken, according to the official.

Boosting tax collection

After a meeting with Assistant Revenue Officers, Senior Revenue Officers, and bill collectors on July 1, the GCC launched a special property tax collection drive, extending collection hours from 8 a.m. to 6 p.m., to expedite tax collection and settle bill arrears.

The civic body is also working towards improving its credit rating to access non-sovereign lending, including from the

Asian Development Bank, the official added.

Meanwhile, a senior official in the Bus Route Roads Department said several tenders for road and footpath works had been cancelled mainly due to a sharp increase in bitumen price, making contractors unwilling to carry out works at older rates.

"After completing nearly ₹100 crore worth of roadwork this year, tenders for another ₹100 crore have been put on hold. Fresh blacktop road relaying has largely been deferred until bitumen price stabilises, though cement concrete roads, footpaths, and interlocking paver block works are continuing. Roads that have already been milled have been prioritised for immediate relaying," the official added.

Man held after minor son causes fatal road accident

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Traffic Police arrested a 42-year-old man for allowing his 17-year-old son to ride a motorcycle, which caused an accident that killed one person in Pulianthope.

The police said that when Madhura, 54, of Gurusamy

Nagar was cycling near a private school on Pulianthope High Road on June 28, a speeding motorcycle collided with him. Madhura sustained a head injury in the fall. A 108 ambulance team provided first aid at the spot, and he returned home since he appeared to be stable. However, his condition worsened, and he was ad-

mitted to the Government Stanley Medical College Hospital.

Based on a complaint, the Pulianthope Traffic Police registered a case and launched an investigation. Madhura succumbed to his injuries on the afternoon of July 4. Following his death, the case was altered to include charges relating to

causing death by negligent driving and other relevant provisions.

During the investigation, the police found that a 17-year-old boy rode the motorcycle. The police arrested the boy's father, Amirjan of Pulianthope, on Sunday for enabling underage driving. He was remanded in judicial custody.

Free textbooks to be offered to college students

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

RYA Book Bank is offering free textbooks for college students of all courses,

including engineering and commerce.

Engineering students in their second year or above are eligible for this scheme. Those interested

can collect the free application forms from the office located at Atkinson Palace, Jothi Venkatachalam Road, Vepery, from 10.30 a.m. to 5.30 p.m.

Students can also download the forms at www.ryabookbank.com.

The last day for applying is July 20. For details, contact 044-25610978.

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2337353, FAX No. 0471-3045647),
E-mail: edrugs.kmscd@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscd.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616
No.KMSCL/ED/22/2025 Date: 04.07.2026
RE-TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited for the procurement of Anti Haemophilia Drugs vide e-tender no KMSCL/ED/HEAM/RT/2026/018 dtd. 04.07.2026 for Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Kerala.

Sl. No.	Name of Item	Last Date & time of Uploading of tender	Date & time of Technical Bid opening
1.	Recombinant Anti Haemophilic factor VIII Standard Half Life 500 IU	14.07.2026 5.00 pm.	16.07.2026 5.00 pm.

Tender documents can be downloaded from the website www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.
(S/d-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

Punjab State Transmission Corporation Limited,
Regd. Office: PSEB Head office, The Mall, Patiala 147001
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org
O/o: Dy. CE/TS(Design), Telefax: 0175-2207774, E-mail:se-trd@pstcl.org
Notice Inviting E-Tender (Short Term)

Tender Enquiry No.	STQ-7099
SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, DELIVERY, SUCCESSFUL OPERATION AT SITE AND ANNUAL MAINTENANCE OF SELF PROPELLED ARTICULATED BOOM (MOTORIZED WORKING PLATFORM) 400 AND 220KV SUBSTATIONS. 1. Last date & time for submission of tender- 03.08.2026 upto 11:00 AM 2. Date & time for opening of tender- 05.08.2026 at 11:00 AM	

Detailed NIT/specification may be downloaded from Punjab Govt. e-tendering website <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in/nicgepp/app>.
Corrigendum, if any, will not be published in newspapers. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates.
1078/12/2026-27/13002 Dy CE/TS (D), PSTCL, Patiala.

MANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka undertaking)
Corporate Office, "MESCOM BHAVANA", Bejai, Mangalore - 575 004
Ph: 0824-2885795 CIN: U40109 KA 2002 SGC 030425
No. E- 3300131/242701/2026 Date: 02.07.2026
TENDER NOTIFICATION (THROUGH KPP PORTAL ONLY)
MESCOM invites tender for Procurement of following material:

Sl. No	Tender No	Name of the Material proposed for Procurement	Quantity
1	MESCOM/2026-27/IND0163	Safety Shoes as per Technical Specifications	3,500 Pairs

The interested eligible bidders may log on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/> on or after 07.07.2026
Sd/-
Superintending Engineer (Ele) (Procurement)
DIPR/DK/MSKMA/474/26-27/dt: 06.07.2026
For Power Related Complaints contact:
MESCOM Helpline: 1912
9483041912 mescom_official mescom_official

ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, BHOPAL
(An Autonomous Institute under MoH&FW, Government of India)
Saket Nagar, Bhopal (M.P.)-462020, www.aiimsbhopal.edu.in
Advt.No. ADM-2(5)/2026/AIIMS/IBPL/AP_Contractual/5130 Date: 06/07/2026
INTERVIEW FOR ENGAGEMENT OF ASSISTANT PROFESSOR ON CONTRACTUAL BASIS IN VARIOUS DEPARTMENTS AT AIIMS BHOPAL
All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Bhopal will hold an Interview for engagement as Assistant Professor in various departments on purely contractual basis with fixed monthly remuneration. For details of essential eligibility criteria, terms & conditions of engagement, application form, application procedure and the date(s) of document verification & Interview, the detailed advertisement may be referred on the Institute's website- www.aiimsbhopal.edu.in. Candidates fulfilling the eligibility criteria and aspiring to attend the interview may submit their application in the prescribed format on recruitment.contractual@aiimsbhopal.edu.in within 10 days from the date of publication of this advertisement on Institute's website. The date of interview and document verification shall be notified separately on Institute's website.
Sd/-
Administrative Officer
AIIMS, Bhopal

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
NIT No. ST-CON-ROU-UTILITY-SHIFT, dated 02.07.2026, Open e-Tender is invited by Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/ Con/HQ/Garden Reach, S.E.Railway for and on behalf of President of India for the following work: **Name of works** : Provision of Supply, execution, testing and commissioning of outdoor and indoor S&T works in connection with Utility Shifting to facilitate Engineering Works for yard remodeling at stations in Sini-Kandra, Gamharia-Chandil, Dangoaposi-Jaroli, Bimalgarh-Barasuan Sections and Badampahar Yard in Chakradharpur Division of S.E.Railway. **Advised value of Tender** : ₹ 4,19,47,226.70. **Earnest Money** : ₹ 8,39,000/-. **Tender document cost** : 0. **Closing Date/Time** : 31.07.2026, 15.00 hrs. Detailed of above Tender Notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in (PR-425)

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

Centre For Railway Information Systems
Channayapur, New Delhi-110021
Tender No.: 01255431C
Tender Title : Supply of Technical Manpower for Projects under CRIS
Date of Closing: 27.07.2026 (Monday) 15:00 hrs.
Tender Documents may be downloaded from Website www.ireps.gov.in. For future modification/extensions pl. see www.ireps.gov.in.

INDIAN RAILWAYS
PATIALA LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
PATIALA - 147003
Tel.: 2396000, 2396001, Fax No. : 91-0175-2306413
Notice Inviting Electronic Tenders
On behalf of President of India Principal Chief Materials Manager/PLW/Patiala invites tenders in electronic form for following items:
e-Tender Notice No. 14 ET/2026-27

S. No.	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	Tender Closing Date
1	112650378	VVVF Drive Complete Bogie Testing Plant	01 No.	22.07.2026
2	112650368	EOT Crane Cap 30/5 Ton	01 No.	31.07.2026
3	02261118	Air Box ASM	32 Nos.	24.07.2026

Tender closing Time 15:00 Hrs.
The prospective Tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or <http://www.plw.indianrailways.gov.in>, for detailed description of items & terms and conditions of tender document. Please note that Tenderers can submit their quotations only through <http://www.ireps.gov.in>.
Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 09 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 20261116 may be read as 10.07.2026.
Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 08 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 01261046 may be read as 13.07.2026.
Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 43 ET/2025-26
Closing date of Tender No. 21250007 may be read as 18.08.2026.
Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 11 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 02261039 may be read as 21.07.2026.
2299/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
CHENNAI DIVISION (WORKS BRANCH)
E-TENDER NOTICE No.20/2026 DATED: 03.07.2026

Sl. No	Item No	Description
1	MAS20OF26093S	Manufacture and Supply of welding portions for 52/60 kg rails for various track works in Sr.DEN/South/MAS Jurisdiction. Zone-C1-WST-Parts of jurisdiction of Pway section namely WST & AVD lying inside Chennai city limits as under:- (i) MAS-AJJ sec up to VLK km.9/30(ind) (Excl. BBQ Coaching yard, ELS/RPM) (ii) MSB VLVCY sec. up to Velachery (ind) (iii) Other areas in Chennai City limit.
2	MAS20OF26094C	Zone C2- Maintenance of all buildings, signal cabins and platform, P.way, watering arrangements, fencing and walling station buildings, staff qrs., service buildings etc. excluding AVD Car shed & ZETTC -AVD in SSE/P.way/AVD SECTION.
3	MAS20OF26095C	Zone C3- Maintenance of AVD Car shed & ZETTC AVD in SSE/P.way/AVD SECTION
4	MAS20OF26096C	Zone C4-TRL-PATLABIRAM West Cabin (excl) to Arakkonam Jn.(excl) 28/8 to 67/18. (entire Thiruvallur P.Way Jurisdiction)
5	MAS20OF26097C	ZONAL C5-BBQ COACHING YARD- Maintenance of service building and sheds ,watering arrangements , roads , pitlines, pathways etc.
6	MAS20OF26098C	Zone C6- ELS/Royapuram-Maintenance of Service buildings & sheds, watering arrangements, road, pit lines, path way etc.,
7	MAS20OF26099C	Zonal C7-Sr.DEN/Central/MAS Jurisdiction Execution of work and supply of materials over the zones BR C1,C2,C3,C4
8	MAS20OF26100C	Repairs & Improvement of Sewerage Facilities, Storm Water Drainage, Roads & Tracking Path and Welfare Building of NWL section.
9	MAS20OF26101C	

Date and Time of Tender Opening:- 27.07.2026 @ 11:30 Hrs.
Complete details & Tender Document will be available at <http://www.ireps.gov.in>
Divisional Railway Manager/Works/Chennai-03

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Batch No.: 13/26 dated 03.07.2026
For and on behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager, East Central Railway invites e-tenders for supply of the following items:
Sl.No. : 1, Tender No. : 04260056, Brief Description : Axle Box Housing (Finish Machined) to ICF, **Quantity :** 1338 Nos, **Due Date :** 20.07.26, **Due Time :** 14:00
Sl.No. : 2, Tender No. : 03263652A, Brief Description : Ring Adathan 2300H (Elastic Ring), **Quantity :** 860 Nos, **Due Date :** 27.07.26, **Due Time :** 14:00
Sl.No. : 3, Tender No. : 14245005, Brief Description : 320 KVA DG Set AMF control panel, **Quantity :** 3 Nos, **Due Date :** 27.07.26, **Due Time :** 14:00
Note : All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenderers are requested to submit their bids online through the IREPS website at www.ireps.gov.in. All corrigendum to above-mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website.
AMM Cum-Secy to PCMM
E.C. Railway, Hajipur
PR/0501/HQ/STORE/T/26-27/36

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS
MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras
Music Academy - Radel Mid Year Concerts Today: From 5.30 p.m. to 7 p.m. At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall - Sarvepalli Sisters - Dr. Sreya & Dr. Rajalakshmi (Vocal Duet), Pantula Vennela (Violin), S. Srivatsa (Mridangam) - From 7.15 p.m. to 8.45 p.m. - P. Vikram (Vocal), Prithvi Bhaskar (Violin), Malladi Sree Aravind (Mridangam) - Programme under the endowment instituted by M/s. Radel Electronics and dedicated to the memory of Smt. Sugandha Raman.

Pushpanjali Cultural Trust
Today 5.30 p.m at R.K. Swamy Auditorium Mylapore Bharathanatyam by KUM MAITREYI MEENAKSHI SUNDAR (Dis. of Smt. Ashwini Viswanathan) 7 p.m Bharathanatyam by students of Smt. Anagha Anishkumar.

Sarvani Sangeetha Sabha Trust 9940418424
Today 6.15 p.m at Raga Sudha Hall. Celebration of 96th Jayanthi of Dr. Mangalampalli Bala muralikrishna garu with MURALEE GANAM - Sreeranjane Kaushik, Bombay Madhavan, Trivandrum Balaji & Dr.S.Karthick. All are welcome.

The Mylapore Fine Arts Club (Regd.) Phone: 24997755/42607755
22nd Year Drama Festival Today 6.45 P.M KALLABIRAMAM by P.Muthukumar. All are welcome.

MISCELLANEOUS
The Madras Sanskrit College Today 6.15 p.m KULTHALAI ARANGASAMI IYER MEIKANDA SAIVA SIDDHANTAM ENDOWMENT LECTURE on "Saiva Siddhantam as per Meikanda Sastram" by Shivastri V. Somasekara Shivacharya at The Madras Sanskrit College, Mylapore. All are welcome.

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Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

CORRIGENDUM NO. 02 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. M-TSK-2026-19
Corrigendum no. 02 against Tender Notice No. M-TSK-2026-19, Date: 05-06-2026 has been issued. Bidders are requested to visit website www.ireps.gov.in.
Sr. DME/Tinsukia
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PERSONAL	PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME I, Ansh Hiren Dani, S/o. Hiren Dani, R/o H1 544, Brigade Xanadu Bonito, Changanagallu Main Road, Annamalai Avenue, Nambur, Chennai - 600095 have changed my name to Ansh Dani for all purposes I, ABITHA MUHAMMED KASSALI, R/o. No. 4/65 Mangali Amman Koil Street, Chennai-16 changed my name as ABITHA THARAVAR HABIBULLAH I, M.MADHURAJ s/o Manogaran born on 12/06/1971 residing at 2/16, Devil street, ilango nagar, Menambedu, Ambattur, Chennai- 600053, have changed my name to Madhura Manogaran vide affidavit dated 06/07/2026 at Chennai. I, VIVEKANANDHAN Koteswaran, Residing at Plot 146 Door No. 4/610 Kanaraj Avenue 1st street Sithalapakkam Kancheepuram 600131, have Changed my name to Vivekanandhan Koteswaran for all future purposes. My initial K in my Aadhaar & PAN & Voter ID stands for Koteswaran. I, Purna Bhahadur, S/o. Krishna Bahadur, DOB : 31/05/1969 Address: Plot no 2, Chalthiran 1st Street, Veppampattu, Thiruvallur, Tamil Nadu - 602024. Shall henceforth be known as K. Purna Bahadur - Purna Bahadur	CHANGE OF NAME I, THIYAGARAJAN Subramani, s/o: Subramani Kanthappa Reddy, r/o: 212, Mandhavelli Street, Pandravedu, Tiruvallur - 631208. Have changed my name as Thiyyagarajan Subramanyam. I, M.MADHURAJ s/o Manogaran born on 12/06/1971 residing at 2/16, Devil street, ilango nagar, Menambedu, Ambattur, Chennai- 600053, have changed my name to Madhura Manogaran vide affidavit dated 06/07/2026 at Chennai. OLD AGE HOME PALLIATIVE CARE at your home Trained Nurses, 24/7, Dr. Physio visits, Lab tests 1800-313-1883 tikotra.com/seniors THANKSGIVING THANK YOU Sacred Heart of Jesus, Mother Mary, St.Joseph, St.Antony, St.Jude and St.Expedite for favours received.

CLASSIFIEDS SPECIAL

Mega Handicrafts Expo
(An Exclusive Exhibition-cum-Sale of Handicrafts and Handlooms)
On Tuesday, 7th July 2026, 10.30 am at **GOVERNMENT MUSEUM** Egmore, Chennai
Inauguration by **Thiru. P. Mathan Raja**, Hon'ble Minister for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)
In the presence of **Thiru. T.N. Venkatesh, IAS.,** Principal Secretary to Government, Handlooms, Handicrafts, Textiles and Khadi Department
Tmt. S. Amirtha Jothi, IAS., Managing Director, Tamil Nadu Handicrafts, Development Corporation Limited
Exhibition from 07.07.2026 to 19.07.2026
Between 10.00 a.m. and 08.00 p.m. (Including Sunday)
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No. 108, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600 002.
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INBRIEF



R. RAGU

300 barricades donated to Greater Chennai Traffic Police

Hyundai Motor India Foundation (HMIF), on Monday, donated 300 road safety barricades to Greater Chennai Traffic Police (GCTP) to enhance traffic management and strengthen road safety infrastructure in the city. The donation comprised 200 iron barricades, 50 steel barricades, and 50 foldable barricades. The barricades were formally handed over to Greater Chennai Police Commissioner A. Amalraj by C.S. Gopalakrishnan, Trustee, Hyundai Motor India Foundation, and Whole-time Director and Chief Manufacturing Officer of Hyundai Motor India Limited, at the Rajarathinam Stadium.

Timings CHENNAI

TUESDAY, JUL. 07

RISE 05:49 SET 18:40

RISE 23:48 SET 11:39

WEDNESDAY, JUL. 08

RISE 05:49 SET 18:40

RISE 00:00 SET 12:31

THURSDAY, JUL. 09

RISE 05:49 SET 18:40

RISE 00:30 SET 13:28

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	35	25
Chennai Airport	35	23
Chennai City	34	25

Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be mostly dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night also will be uneasy.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
38°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be slightly hot and uneasy. Night also will be uneasy. Mostly dry weather to prevail.

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Chief Minister visits desalination plants at Nemmeli

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday inspected the desalination plants at Nemmeli with capacities of 110 million litres per day (MLD) and 150 MLD, besides reviewing the progress of the 400 MLD desalination plant being constructed at Perur at an estimated cost of ₹5,814.57 crore.

During the visit, the Chief Minister drank water produced at the Nemmeli desalination plants to underscore its quality and safety.

He inspected various components of the facili-



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay drinking water from the Nemmeli desalination plants on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ties, including the intake structure, lamella clarifier, reverse osmosis permeate tank, neutralisation pit, product water tank, clear water reservoir, sludge thickener, administrative

building, warehouse, limestone filter, reverse osmosis building, reverse osmosis feed tank, dissolved air flotation unit, gravity dual media filter, chemical building, electrical build-



Modern facility: An artist's impression of the Phase II Thirumangalam Metro station project. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

kam, Kovilambakkam, and Perumbakkam to reach Sholinganallur, running for a distance of 47 km and comprising both elevated and underground stretch-

es. Adjacent to the elevated Thirumangalam Metro station, which is coming up on 3.85 acres, four towers will be built. The towers will be linked to the station

by a skywalk, and trains will pass through the second tower. According to officials of Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL), they have finalised the contract for building the four towers, with the estimated cost being nearly ₹400 crore. The towers will house shopping areas and office spaces while also providing easy access to the Metro Rail network.

“As the design for the commercial hub is already ready, there will no further delays. The contract will be awarded within a few

weeks, and work will begin in September,” an official said. From the date of the award of contract, the firm will have two and a half years to complete the construction of this project.

Krishna Raj M.R. of Thirumangalam said: “While the project can make the locality more vibrant and make commuting easier, meeting deadlines is equally important. There is no doubt that Metro Rail has made commuting convenient but they have to be reasonable and complete the construction on time.”

THE HINDU
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APPOINTMENT

इण्डियन ओवरसीज़ बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
Central Office, 763, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600002

Engagement of Apprentices under Apprentices Act, 1961 - FY 2026-27 (750 Vacancies)

Indian Overseas Bank, a leading Public Sector Bank with headquarters in Chennai having geographical presence all over India and abroad, invites applications from eligible candidates, for the captioned engagement process. The detailed advertisement regarding the eligibility such as Age, Qualification & Other requirements are available in the Bank's website www.iob.bank.in under "Careers" page

Online Registration:
07.07.2026 - 20.07.2026 (Both days inclusive)
Payment of Application / Examination Fee / Intimation Charges:
07.07.2026 - 22.07.2026 (Both days inclusive)

WANTED

SENIOR LAW OFFICERS AND LAW GRADUATES FOR KALAIMAGHAL SABHA

Experienced Advocates and Law Graduates are required on full time and Part time basis.

Salary for senior law officers (Full time basis) : Rs.60,000 /-
Salary for Law graduates (Full time basis) : Rs.50,000 /-
Interested person can send their resume to Kalaimaghal sabha
Email Id: specialofficerkms2022@gmail.com.
Shortlisted Candidates will be called for an interview.

Special Officer Kalaimaghal sabha

Date : 06.07.2026
Place : Chennai
DIPPR/592/Display/2026

No.17/48, North usman road,
T.Nagar, Chennai – 600 017.

SOUTHERN RAILWAY				
E- Tender Notice No. SA/OT/07/2026 dt:03/07/2026 DRM/Works/Salem invites E-TENDERS for the works:				
Item No	Name of work	Value in (₹)	EMD in (₹)	Completion period (Months)
01	Reconstruction of Type-III staff quarters 12 units in lieu of condemned Qtrs No.21A-D/ SXT, 20A-D/ATU and 5A-D/CHSM in SA-VRI section.	3,69,82,201	7,39,700	09
02	TFR (plain track) - 43.561 km and TFR (P&C) - 23 sets	2,48,02,194	4,96,100	04
03	Provision of Minimum Essential Amenities (MEA) and other additional Divyanjan facilities in over all Salem Division. (For DEN/Central/SA Jurisdiction)	4,62,72,320	9,25,500	04
04	Repairs to existing side drain with RCC lined drain on one side wall at BQ-3.746 km & CBF-1.2 Km	3,18,16,341	6,36,300	06
05	Provision of Minimum Essential Amenities (MEA) and other additional Divyanjan facilities in over all Salem Division. (For Sr.DEN/West/SA Jurisdiction)	1,94,86,032	3,89,700	04
06	(1) Maintenance of water supply system at TPT, SLY, MAP & BQI Stations & Colony for a period of two years, (2) Providing House Keeping & Hospitality services for Track machine rest house at TPT, SLY, MAP & BQI for a period of two years, (3) Maintenance of Sewer system at TPT, SLY, MAP & BQI for a period of two years, (4) Annual maintenance works of dewatering, deslitting, clearing water courses and removal of bushes/debris, etc in subways located in ADEN/SA Sub Division for the period of 2 years. (Total=11 subways).	1,97,31,020	3,94,600	24
07	1.CTR(S) 60kg -22.631 km and CTR(S) 52kg 0.5km on loop lines & TRR(S) 60kg - 5.146km on loop lines various yards. (Flash butt weld items /LAW 1262/24-25) 2. Conversion of SWR into LWR 15.53 km. (Flash butt weld items only)/LAW 1249/24-25). 3. Through weld Renewal (TWR)- 11.5 km of AT welds into Flash Butt Weld in SA-KRR & SA-VRI sections	12,34,23,561	24,68,500	12
08	SW-4: Re-girding of steel girders in Br.No.342 DN with new metallised steel girders on CV bridge at Km 389/200-700 between in SA-ED section. SW-4I -JTJ-ED Sec: Strengthening of Existing Arch Br.No.87 (18x9.14m)DN line. SW-4II: Rebuilding of minor bridges between JTJ-ED section in ADEN/S/SA subdivision. (36 bridges)	67,87,26,588	1,35,74,500	24
		Item No: 01 03, 04, 05	Any Civil Engineering work except track work/ transportation.	
		Item No:02	Any Track Work	
		Item No:06	Any Civil Engineering Work except track work.	
		Item No:07	Welding of 52Kg/60Kg Rails by MFBW Plant on line under traffic block or otherwise or at stationary MFBW plant.	
		Item No:08	Any Construction / Rehabilitation work of Bridges/ROB/RUB / Subway under rail-traffic conditions.	
		Maintenance period	03 years for item No: 01 04 years for item No:08	
NOTE:(i) Tender closing at 14.00 Hrs on 27/07/2026 (applicable to item Nos. 1 to 7). (ii) Tender closing at 14.00 Hrs on 10/08/2026 (applicable to item No.8). (iii) It is the responsibility of the tenderers to check any Congendum is issued for any changes. For complete Details, please visit web site at www.reps.gov.in DRM/Works/Salem				

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY	
E-TENDER NOTICE	
E-Tenders are invited for execution of the following works by Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), E. C. Railway, Dhanbad:-	
SL.No.: 1, E-Tender No.: 124-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Provision of cleaning and pumping arrangement for accumulated water from RUB in KQR-ARGD and KQR-MMD section under ADEN/KQR. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 59,29,772.95	Nos. Double Bed Room) under ADEN/1/ GMO. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,09,38,003.82
SL.No.: 2, E-Tender No.: 125-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Provision of 3.0 m wide FOB at LBT. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 4,22,76,633.06	SL.No.: 13, E-Tender No.: 136-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : GMO- Upgradation of Crew lobby at GMO under ADEN/1/GMO. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,12,68,989.12
SL.No.: 3, E-Tender No.: 126-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Provision of ramp (with all Divyang facilities) in the FOB of TORI station. 18 (Eighteen) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 3,39,30,508.99	SL.No.: 14, E-Tender No.: 137-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Provision of water booth, Toilet, Lean-to-shed, vacuum dewatering concrete surface on PF at BNSL, TKN, BNF, BSCP, NGY & GJD station, VDC concrete Surfacing of PF at YGM & Provision of RDSO type PF shed at GJD, DLW, TKN, BNF, YGM, BNSL & GAP including other ancillary work. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 3,85,81,552.14
SL.No.: 4, E-Tender No.: 127-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Maintenance works at existing LHS including Sweeping, Dewatering & Painting under jurisdiction in Sr.DEN/1/DHN. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 54,92,968.28	SL.No.: 15, E-Tender No.: 138-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Upgradation of maintenance facility at pit no. 01 in coaching depot DHN for maintenance for Vande Bharat and Amrit Bharat under ADEN/1/DHN. 04 (Four) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 8,92,994.09
SL.No.: 5, E-Tender No.: 128-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Repairs service building at Patratu, Hendegir & Tokisud & BRKA under SSE/WPTRU & BRKA under jurisdiction of ADEN/BRKA. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 54,99,740.17	SL.No.: 16, E-Tender No.: 139-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : DHN-Improvement of main pipe line & Deep tube well at Dhanbad station to cater water crisis in summer under ADEN/1/DHN. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,30,27,921.63
SL.No.: 6, E-Tender No.: 129-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Repairs of damaged member, Protective Screen, roofing sheet, painting, & chequered tiles etc. of various FOB under jurisdiction of ADEN/2/GMO. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 69,97,558.60	SL.No.: 17, E-Tender No.: 140-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : DHN- Replacement of 4 units Type-IV staff Quarters of Rangataand colony & 4 units Type-I of W & W colony by 8 units Type-IV quarters at DHN under ADEN/1/DHN. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,95,25,060.26
SL.No.: 7, E-Tender No.: 130-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : GMIA-Improvement of approach road of Gomia station. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 28,61,004.30	SL.No.: 18, E-Tender No.: 141-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Provision of HL PF at DXN (PF No. 1), JRQ (PF No.1), JGF (PF No.1) & GMX (PF No.1) under ADEN/RNG. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 6,82,52,508.74
SL.No.: 8, E-Tender No.: 131-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Provision of Gabion Box wall to protect cutting in BRKA-SDWR section at Km 143/19-22 under ADEN/BRKA. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 1,33,27,386.75	SL.No.: 19, E-Tender No.: 142-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : SKTN- Construction of quarters (Type-III/4 & Ty-IV-4 units). 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,09,86,005.93
SL.No.: 9, E-Tender No.: 132-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Dhanbad Division: Provision of Track Machine Siding length 300m- 2 Nos., under ADEN/2/GMO. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 3,11,89,209.12	SL.No.: 20, E-Tender No.: 143-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Construction of New staff Quarter at OBRA (Ty-IV-4 units & Ty-III-8 units) under ADEN/CPU. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,84,76,798.62
SL.No.: 10, E-Tender No.: 133-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Provision of facilities for Divyanjan like water booth, toilet, Help booth, lean-to-shed with seating arrangement at MESR, SANI, SDWR & ARGD stations and FOB ramp at SANI, SDWR & ARGD stations in the jurisdiction of ADEN/BRKA. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 4,54,97,412.34	SL.No.: 21, E-Tender No.: 144-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Construction of Side Drain under Sr. DEN.5 - 1.9 Km in section KQR-MMD- 1.9 Km. (SL). 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,20,15,100.63
SL.No.: 11, E-Tender No.: 134-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : BRMO & GMIA- Provision of FOB with ramp at Bermo station and Ramp in the FOB of Gomia. 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 5,07,07,021.32	SL.No.: 22, E-Tender No.: 145-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : Construction of Side Drain under Sr. DEN.5 - 2.00 Km in section KQR-ARGD- 2.00 Km. (SL). 12 (Twelve) Months, Approx. cost of work (In Rs.): 2,31,73,872.29
SL.No.: 12, E-Tender No.: 135-DHN-2026-27, Name of the work with its location & completion period : GMO- Extension of Running Room at GMO for 40 Nos. Beds (20	Earnest Money (In Rs.): Earnest Money is applicable as shown in http://www.reps.gov.in portal. Date & Time for closing and opening of e-tender : Date of closing of e-tender at 12:00 hours on 27.07.2026. Date of opening of e-tender from 12:30 hrs. on 27.07.2026. Website particulars : http://www.reps.gov.in No manual tender will be accepted against e-tendering.
Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering) East Central Railway/Dhanbad PR/0502/DHN/ENGG/T/26-27/200	

VINAYAKA MISSION'S RESEARCH FOUNDATION
(Deemed to be University under section 3 of the UGC Act 1956)

Cordially Invites you to the

19th CONVOCACTION
வது பட்டமளிப்பு விழா
07.07.2026

Chief Guest

Padma Bhushan Dr. K. R. Palaniswamy
MBBS, MD, DM (Gastroenterology)
Senior Consultant - Apollo Hospitals, Chennai.
Will deliver the convocation address

Honoris Causa to be conferred upon

Prof. Dr. S. Rajasekaran
M.S. (Ortho), D.Ortho, D.N.B, F.R.C.S. (Ed.), F.R.C.S. (UK), M.Ch. (Liverpool), FACS, Ph.D., Chairman, Ganga Hospital, Coimbatore. &

Mr. Caldwell Velnambi
Member, Tamil Nadu Government's Commissionerate of Rehabilitation & Welfare of Non-Resident Tamils
Former President - Federation of Tamil Sangams of North America (FeTNA).

Mrs. ANNAPOORANI SHANMUGASUNDARAM
Trustee
Dato' Seri. Dr. S. SHARAVANAN
President
Will grace the occasion

Dr. A.S. GANESAN
Chancellor
Will preside over the convocation

Prof. Dr. A. NAGAPPAN
REGISTRAR

Prof. Dr. J. SABARINATHAN
Pro Vice-Chancellor

Prof. Dr. P.K. SUDHIR
Vice-Chancellor

Our Campuses: Salem | Chennai | Puducherry | Karaikal

Medicine | Dentistry | Homoeopathy | Engineering & Technology | Pharmacy | Nursing | Physiotherapy | Law | Management | Arts & Science | Physical Education | Allied Health Sciences | Rehabilitation and Behavioral Sciences | Interdisciplinary Studies | Liberal Arts | Public Health | EPALM | Research

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From Page One

T.N. defends CRZ nod for Mamallan Reservoir

The reservoir will have a storage capacity of 1.655 tmc ft to address drinking water shortage in the southern parts of the Chennai Metropolitan Area. It said the reservoir would cater to around 50,000 residents in areas including Nemmeli, Krishnankaranai, Pattipulam, Paiyanur, Kalavakkam, Thiruporur, Thiruvidanthai, and Mamallapuram, besides mitigating floods and seawater intrusion.

The counter-affidavit said the proposal was examined by the Chengalpattu District Coastal Zone Management Authority (DCZMA), the Technical Expert Committee, the State Expert Appraisal Committee, IIT-Madras, and TNSCZMA before the CRZ clearance was granted.

It argued that the project falls within the purview of activities permitted under the CRZ Notification, 2011, and subsequent clarifications issued by the Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change for public utilities such as water supply, salinity prevention, and freshwater recharge.

The authority contended that the project does not involve reclamation of the sea, estuary, or tidal waters, but is proposed entirely on inland floodplain *poromboke* land.

The counter-affidavit said the clearance was granted subject to several conditions.

The project has, however, drawn sustained opposition from fishing communities and environmental experts. Fisher representatives from villages along the Nemmeli-Kovalam backwaters have alleged that they were not consulted before the project was approved, and that the reservoir would affect the livelihoods of thousands of inland and marine fishers dependent on the brackish water ecosystem. They also contended that converting the tidal marsh into a freshwater reservoir could increase flood risk to neighbouring villages and damage fisheries, mangroves, and the estuarine ecosystem.

INBRIEF



BJP criticises Chief Minister over law and order situation

BJP Tamil Nadu president Nainar Nagenthiran on Monday criticised Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay over various crimes reported across the State, and claimed that law and order was deteriorating. Condemning the alleged abduction of a Congress functionary in Coimbatore and the attempt to murder a girl in Virudhunagar, he criticised the TVK-led government for being “a mute spectator” to these incidents. “The fact that Mr. Vijay is struggling to provide safety at public spaces even to functionaries of parties constituting the TVK-led government exposes his administrative failure,” Mr. Nagenthiran said. The people who voted for change were now fearing for their lives, he added.

DMK’s Gen Z wing leader withdraws anticipatory bail plea in ‘derogatory’ post case

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

DMK Gen Z wing leader A. Anbanantham on Monday withdrew the anticipatory bail petition he had filed before the Madras High Court in a case registered under the Indecent Representation of Women (Prohibition) Act, 1986, for his “derogatory” Instagram post that made references to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, his wife, son, and an actor.

Justice C. Kumarappan dismissed the plea as withdrawn. The petitioner’s counsel chose to withdraw the plea after finding that the judge was not inclined to grant the relief. “This [the Instagram post] affects the conscience of society. He has taken everything as carte blanche. I am not inclined to grant him anticipatory bail,” the judge told the counsel before permitting him to withdraw the petition.

Though the counsel said he would ask the petitioner



Anbanantham

to file an affidavit of apology, along with an undertaking that he would not make such remarks in the future, the judge said he was still not inclined to grant the anticipatory bail, as the Instagram post had already reached millions of people.

The Rayakottai police in Krishnagiri district had registered the FIR against the petitioner on June 23 on the basis of a complaint filed by M. Moorthy, an office-bearer of the ruling TVK in Krishnagiri.

According to the complainant, the petitioner had made highly disparaging remarks against the

CM opposes amendment to National Food Security Act

In a letter to PM, he urges the Centre to retain the existing entitlement of 35 kg of foodgrains per month for every household covered under the Antyodaya Anna Yojana, irrespective of family size

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday urged the Centre to retain the existing entitlement of 35 kg of foodgrains per month for every household covered under Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY), irrespective of the number of family members, as has been the practice since the enactment of the National Food Security Act (NFSA).

In a letter to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, he requested the Centre to reconsider the proposed amendment to the first proviso to sub-section (1) of Section 3 of the National Food Security Act, 2013.

“If the proposed amendment is brought into force, it would diminish the food security of nearly 70 lakh of Tamil Nadu’s most vulnerable citizens,” he said.

He pointed out that while the existing provision guarantees 35 kg of foodgrains per household every month, irrespective



of family size, the proposed amendment seeks to provide 7 kg per person per month, subject to an overall ceiling of 35 kg per household.

Though the Union government had explained that the amendment was intended to remove intra-category inequities and align entitlements more closely with nutritional requirements, its practical effect would be a substantial reduction in the quantity of foodgrains reaching the poorest households in Tamil Nadu, where the average family size is only 3.54 members, he said.

Tamil Nadu has 18,64,600 AAY ration cards, covering 69,26,983 beneficiaries. These households

If the proposed amendment is brought into force, it would diminish the food security of nearly 70 lakh of Tamil Nadu’s most vulnerable citizens

C. JOSEPH VIJAY
Chief Minister

belong to the most vulnerable sections of society, identified under the Centre’s eligibility guidelines, including families headed by widows, persons with disabilities, elderly persons without a regular source of income, tribal families, landless agricultural labourers, daily wage earners, and those suffering from life-threatening illnesses.

“These are precisely the households that the National Food Security Act was designed to protect through an assured, unconditional entitlement. The Act was enacted by Parliament as a measure of last-resort protection for the poorest of the poor, and its entitlements were

deliberately framed to be simple, unconditional and household-based so that no family, regardless of its size, is left without adequate foodgrains or exposed to hidden hunger and malnutrition,” he said.

He argued that converting the entitlement into a per-capita benefit, while retaining a household-level ceiling, would effectively penalise States with smaller families, particularly those in southern India that have successfully implemented the Union government’s family planning programme.

Tamil Nadu is predominantly a rice-consuming State, and the rice supplied to AAY beneficiaries constitutes the staple food for all three meals of the day, he said. “It cannot be substituted with any other commodity purchased from the open market. Any reduction in the entitlement would impose a significant financial burden on these families, pushing them towards poverty, malnutrition and hunger,” he added.

Suggestion made at AIADMK meeting to bring Dhinakaran back into party

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

A suggestion to bring AMMK founder T.T.V. Dhinakaran back into the AIADMK was made during a meeting of AIADMK office-bearers, chaired by party general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami, in Thanjavur on Monday.

Padma Kumaresan, a functionary, who articulated this point at the meeting, said that when he conveyed the idea to Mr. Palaniswami, he heard it “intently”, and replied that Mr. Dhinakaran was running a party of his own.

A senior functionary of the party, who was present at the meeting, confirmed the exchange of views. The matter did not figure again in the subsequent deliberations, he added.



AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami with AMMK leader T.T.V. Dhinakaran. FILE PHOTO

Thanjavur was one of the districts where the AIADMK and its allies drew a blank. In neighbouring Mayiladuthurai, too, the coalition led by the Dravidian major fared poorly. Put together, the two districts have 11 constituencies.

Dr. Elaiyaraja had alleged that he was contacted by a man named Thirunavukkarasu at the behest of certain functionaries of a major political party.

According to the complaint, Thirunavukkarasu had sought the MLA’s cooperation during a vote on a proposed no-confidence motion against the Assembly Speaker, and had offered him up to ₹35 crore in return.

Based on the complaint lodged by the MLA with the Chennai City Police Commissioner, the Triplicane police registered a case and arrested Thirunavukkarasu of Arumbakkam, Nares of Tiruchi, Thiagarajan of Medavakkam, and six others.

The police said the investigation had revealed that Ashok Kumar met Nares in Chennai. The probe also indicated that Thirunavukkarasu had contacted the MLA and carried out the alleged bribery attempt on the instructions of Mr. Senthilbalaji and Mr. Ashok Kumar, the police added.

Palaniswami heard it ‘intently’, but replied that Dhinakaran was running his own party now, says a functionary

ruthur, Orathanadu, and Pattukkottai – it came third, while the TVK was the runner-up. In these three places where the DMK won, the AIADMK’s vote share was in the range of 22.66% in Orathanadu to 26.98% in Pattukkottai.

The idea of bringing the AMMK founder back into the party did the rounds about a month ago. When asked about it at the time, Mr. Dhinakaran said he was “even now” with the AIADMK.

POCSO pendency and torturous process further victimise children subjected to sexual abuse

Ramya Kannan

A staggering 18,733 POCSO cases are pending in various courts across the 38 districts in Tamil Nadu, as of June 2026. But the pendency is merely the proverbial tip of the iceberg; the whole problem also includes patchy support services for children who opt to go through the procedural justice system.

Among the courts with the highest pendency of cases are the POCSO Court in Madurai with 1,000 cases unresolved; Tiruppur’s Fast Track Mahila Court with 790 pending cases; Chennai’s POCSO Court with 747 cases; and Tenkasi Principal District Court with 702 cases.

In 2023, the Registrar of the Madras High Court sent a proposal to the State government to start eight special courts exclusively for POCSO cases – one each in Erode, Krishnagiri, Namakkal, the Nilgiris, Ramanaathapuram, Tiruchi, Tiruvallur, and Tiruppur.

“These courts have still not come up,” says Vidya Reddy of Tulir-CPCHSA. It



In Juvenile Justice Boards, which also hear POCSO cases, daily hearings are held only in Chennai.

seems all the starker if you juxtapose it against the pendency of cases in the courts. In the Juvenile Justice Boards, which also hear POCSO cases, daily hearings are held only in Chennai. In the other districts, they are held once or twice a week, and POCSO cases are heard in addition to other cases.

But according to Ms. Reddy, it is not just the pendency that is worrisome. “Once the complaint is registered, the child enters a lengthy process that will lead them to a verdict. While this can be traumatising for the child, the law puts in place sever-

al aspects that could make the process smoother. If the question is: is the bouquet of social sector interventions to assist procedural justice being implemented well, the answer is no,” she says.

Social sector support to the child includes assistance in filing a complaint, including translators or interpreters. Once the police are notified, they are meant to record the complaint and register an FIR, with the assigned police officer recording the statement of the child at his or her home or any location where the child feels comfortable. POCSO cases can even be filed online, but whether these cases are numbered is another question activists raise.

When the child undergoes a medical examination, he/she must get a copy, but the family seldom gets one, says Ms. Reddy.

The Child Welfare Committee is required to appoint a support person (SP) for each case; but how many children actually have one today? In a case that was registered earlier

Senthilbalaji, brother fail to appear for inquiry into alleged bid to bribe TVK MLA

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK MLA and former Minister V. Senthilbalaji and his brother Ashok Kumar failed to appear for an inquiry on Monday, despite being summoned by the Triplicane police in connection with an alleged bid to bribe the TVK’s Uthangarai MLA, N. Elaiyaraja, as part of a conspiracy to topple the government led by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay.

Last week, officers attached to the Triplicane police station travelled to Rameswarapatti village in Karur district and served the summons on the brothers through their parents at their residence. They were directed to appear before the investigating officer at 11 a.m. on Monday.

Sources said the brothers failed to appear as directed. The next course of action would be decided after consultations with legal experts and senior police officers, the sources added.

INBRIEF



Saudi Arabia's low-cost carrier Flyadeal makes India debut

Saudi Arabian low-cost carrier Flyadeal on Monday commenced its India operations with the launch of a daily non-stop service between Hyderabad and Riyadh (using Airbus A320 aircraft), making Rajiv Gandhi International Airport its first destination in the country. The Hyderabad-bound flight departs Riyadh at 11.20 p.m. and arrives at 6.50 a.m. the following day.

A.P. YouTuber charged under UAPA for 'Maoist propaganda'

The Andhra Pradesh Police have registered a case under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) against YouTuber Joseph Bachalakuri alias Prashna Ravan for allegedly propagating Maoist ideology. He was arrested on Sunday and remanded to judicial custody. He has been on bail for several cases registered against him after being arrested on June 30 over remarks against Deputy Chief Minister K. Pawan Kalyan.

Custodial torture allegation clouds POCSCO probe in Kerala

A day after the Kerala police concluded that the sexual abuse allegations made by a 13-year-old girl were false, the case has taken a new turn with a 20-year-old youth – one of the 10 accused – alleging custodial torture. The youth, who was taken into custody during the probe, has lodged a complaint with Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala alleging he was tortured by police.

'Karnataka govt. plotting to derail HMT revival package'

Union Minister for Heavy Industries and Steel H.D. Kumaraswamy on Monday accused the Congress in Karnataka of conspiring to derail the Centre's efforts to revive Hindustan Machine Tools (HMT), alleging that the government was using the Forest Department to create obstacles just when a special revival package for the public sector enterprise was at a crucial stage.

Revathy and Padmapriya quit AMMA

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

Actors Revathy and Padmapriya resigned from the primary membership of the Association of Malayalam Movie Artistes (AMMA) on Monday. "...Our resignation is not in haste and not about a single incident," they said in a joint statement online.

"For nearly a decade, the ask was simple. Safer workplaces. Dignity. Accountability. Equal treatment. The minimum every member deserves. And values we genuinely believed all of us could unite around. The price of asking, for us, has been silence and distance. From colleagues, from friends, from spaces that once felt like home. Still, we stayed. For hope has a remarkable ability to survive disappointment," they said.

The actors, who are the founding members of the Women in Cinema Collective, said the resignations that followed the release of the Hema Committee report on the problems faced by women in Malayalam film industry were not an act of principle.

"They were an escape from accountability. Once the attention faded, the same old order returned. Power keeps finding new ways to protect itself. The faces change. The methods change. But the structures enabling inequality remain untouched," they said.

They pointed out "AMMA was meant to stand as a collective voice... But it has become increasingly shaped by patriarchy and power politics, weakening its founding ideals. Walking away for us is not defeat. It is self-respect."

TAMILNADU CEMENTS CORPORATION LIMITED
(A GOVT. ENTERPRISE)
5 Floor, Avin Illam, No.3A, Pasumpon Muthuramalingam Salai, Madurai, Chennai-600 035.
e-TENDER NOTICE
e-Tender Ref.No:SC2026-27. Appointment of Insurer for General Insurance in respect of all type of policies to TANCEN for the year 2026-27
Est. Value: Rs.83.00 Lakhs
Submission of tender: Up to 12.00 Noon on 21.07.2026
Important Note:
A pre-bid meeting will be held on 14.07.2026 at 3.00 pm at TANCEN, Registered Office, 5th Floor, Avin Illam, No.3A, Pasumpon Muthuramalingam Salai, Nandanam, Chennai-600 035.
The Tender document can be downloaded from <https://tenders.gov.in> Corrigendum / Addendum to this publication, if any would appear only on the above said website.
UPSR/2216/TENDER/2026 General Manager (Marketing)/DRG

SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Follow us on @SCRailwayIndia
Details of the Tender Notices of S.C Railway can be seen on our website : www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER No. GMWSCBSCAN2026-2701, Dt. 04.07.2026

PCE acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Tender No. **GMWSCBSCAN2026-2701** Closing Date/Time **27.07.2026 15:00 Hrs.** Bidders will be able to submit their original / revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

SI. No.: 1, IR-USSOR 2021 Item No.: 141021 & 141022, Description of work: Carrying out through USFD testing of running Rails & Welds (excluding flange testing) including level crossings, lead portion of points and crossings and scabbed rail testing of all types of Rails by NBC (Need based concept) method under traffic conditions as per provisions of IR's "USFD manual & Specifications for Ultrasonic Testing of Rails and Welds" with latest correction slips & related instructions, duly marking defects, submission of daily reports and storing back up data as specified & directed with Contractor's USFD machine. NOTE: (The SRT/DRT machine should have minimum of 9 probes **B scan** (including 37 degree forward / backward probe for detecting bolt hole cracks) with contractors USFD Machine, **Item Qty:** 8135.00, **QTY Unit:** Per Track Km (Tkm), **Unit Rate:** Rs.5,490.00. **Basic Value in Rs.:** 4,46,61,150.00. Period of Completion: 24 months from the date of commencement of work as mentioned in the letter of acceptance.

For bid document and other details, please login to website <https://www.ireps.gov.in>

Tenderer should watch for any Corrigenda (issued online only) upto the date of commencement of the Tender submission period.

Principal Chief Engineer, Secunderabad

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

Karnataka BLOs on SIR duty not visiting homes, says NDA

BLOs filling enumeration forms in violation of guidelines, NDA delegation alleges in a letter to the CEO; CM rules out intervention, accuses Opposition of depriving minorities of their voting rights

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Alleging 'irregularities' in the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka, NDA leaders led by Union Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy have written to Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V. Anbu Kumar seeking an immediate inquiry into the exercise.

The delegation, including Union Minister Pralhad Joshi, Leader of Opposition R. Ashok, Leader of Opposition in Legislative Council Chalavadi Narayanaswamy, and JD(S) party leader C.B. Suresh Babu submitted a letter to the CEO on



Verification drive: A Booth-Level Officer examines voter details during the SIR of electoral rolls in Chikkamagaluru, Karnataka. PTI

Monday, requesting 're-verification' of all enumeration forms through mandatory door-to-door visits, and strict legal action against those found responsible for irregularities.

The letter pointed out the guidelines require

Booth-Level Officers (BLOs), under the supervision of the District Election Officer, to visit every household, verify the identity of each family member in person, and carry out door-to-door verification. However, this was not hap-

pening in many places, the leaders alleged.

"Instead of visiting homes, the BLOs were filling in enumeration forms from community halls, mosques, and even their own residences," the letter stated, further claiming that WhatsApp groups had been created to carry out the exercise.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Monday ruled out any interference by the government, asserting that the SIR was entirely under the purview of the Election Commission. He also accused the Opposition of attempting to deprive the poor and minorities of their voting rights.

Search continues for missing A.P. fishermen

V. Kamalakara Rao
VISAKHAPATNAM

A massive, coordinated search is under way in the Bay of Bengal after a fishing boat, **IND-AP-MM-VS-83**, capsized in severe weather off the Visakhapatnam coast on Saturday.

Six fishermen are still missing, and the search for them is under way amid turbulent seas and strong winds.

The mechanised boat left the Visakhapatnam Harbour on July 1 for a rou-

tine trip and was due back by the afternoon of Saturday, but did not return.

The crew last made contact on that day, telling their families they were off the Gangavaram coast and heading back. Soon after, the vessel got caught in turbulent weather.

The boat's owner, Kari Chinna, was rescued by a Panama-flagged merchant vessel. The search for the rest of the fishermen has widened with the Indian Coast Guard and Navy joining the efforts.

Kerala, Adani Group seek to mend fences

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Amid differences between the Kerala government and the Adani group over the proposed sale of shares in the Adani Vizhinjam Port Private Limited (AVPPL), the company has said it wants to take the port project to next level only with the support of the State, and the backing of the Centre.

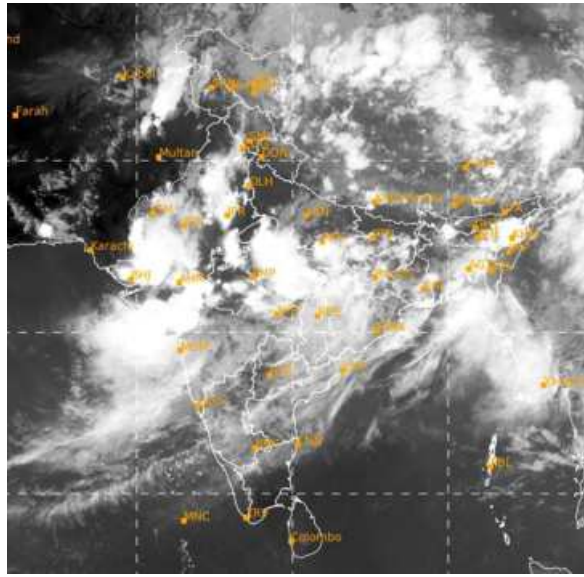
Allaying fears of a monopoly by a shipping line, Aswani Gupta, CEO of Ada-

ni Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ), said that partnering with the Switzerland-based Mediterranean Shipping Company (MSC) does not mean that it will have exclusivity at the port, which is, and will continue to be, open to all partners from around the world.

The State, meanwhile, is exploring possibility of placing conditions on the proposed transfer of stakes and has reportedly sought legal advice from the Advocate-General.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Gujarat, Rajasthan, Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Konkan & Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Mahe

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		32.0	25.8	Kurnool		36.2	26.9
Ahmedabad		35.2	27.0	Lucknow		36.5	28.4
Aizawl		32.0	24.1	Madurai		38.9	26.1
Bengaluru		28.9	20.4	Mangaluru		27.4	29.9
Bhopal		33.4	23.6	Mumbai		27.3	24.0
Bhubaneswar	0.2	32.0	24.4	Mysuru		29.3	20.0
Chandigarh		34.6	28.5	New Delhi		38.6	27.0
Chennai		38.6	28.5	Patna		34.8	28.8
Coimbatore		32.2	23.6	Port Blair		31.2	27.2
Dehradun		34.2	25.7	Prayagraj		34.4	27.8
Gangtok		22.0	19.3	Puducherry		38.9	27.2
Goa		30.2	25.8	Pune		146.8	24.1
Guwahati		34.8	26.6	Raipur		68.9	26.5
Hubballi		34.0	22.0	Ranchi		26.2	23.1
Hyderabad		33.0	24.2	Shillong		1.7	27.4
Imphal		6.2	32.1	Shimla		25.8	21.2
Jaipur		35.7	35.6	Srinagar		31.9	20.8
Kochi		30.8	26.2	Thiruvananthapuram		32.2	25.6
Kohima		26.0	21.0	Tiruchirappalli		38.1	26.6
Kolkata		29.9	26.4	Vijayawada		36.8	27.2
Kozhikode		32.0	27.0	Visakhapatnam		32.7	27.1

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		32	10	39		72	■
Bengaluru		19	24	60		56	■
Chennai		5	5	27		90	■
Delhi		10	40	60		170	■
Hyderabad		10	16	25		45	■
Kolkata		16	21	109		69	■
Lucknow		11	27	34		50	■
Mumbai		8	62	18		45	■
Pune		45	94	34		35	■
Visakhapatnam		17	50	19		44	■

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

S SRINIVASAN (90), retired from Ministry of Finance, Govt of India, passed away on 4 Jul, 2026. Deeply mourned by Chandra, Padma, Ramani, Janaki, Rajen, Venkat, Ulkarsh, other relatives and friends. Fondly remembered for his engaging conversations, his love for Delhi, books and Carnatic music. Sector 60, Gurugram – 122098. Ph. 8197744129

DEATH

SMT.R.V. Ramanamma (76), mother of Ms.Anusha Natarajan, Chennai-600015 expired on 05.07.2026. Eyes donated to Rotary Rajan Eye Bank (Project of Rotary Club of Madras T. Nagar), Chennai-17. (Ph: 26340500).

DEATH

WITH DEEP sadness we announce the passing of Mr N Ramamoorthy (1946 – 2026), s/o of late K. Naganatha Iyer of Konerirajapuram on June 26th. He is survived by his wife, son, son-in-law, daughter, daughter-in-law, grand children and the countless people he influenced.

DEATH

Mrs. JOSEPHINE LEO
Director - A.L. Trans Pvt Ltd
DOB: 30.12.1958 DOD: 06.07.2026
Deeply mourned by
Husband B. Leo Michael, Son,
Daughter in law and Grand children.
Funeral at Our Lady of Good Health Church, Panur, Thiruvallur District on 08.07.2026 at 11AM
Son B.L. Joseph Selvaraj
9840223454

DEATH

Mr. Creswell Dias
Former Director (Engineering), MRF
Passed away on 5th July 2026
Funeral Mass: Tuesday 7th July,
3 pm at St. Joseph's Church, Vepery
Burial: St. Roque's Cemetery
Rest in Peace
Mourned by Family and Friends

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

9th ANNIVERSARY
Remembering every moment
in silent Grief

M.S.RAMAMURTHI
28-09-1937 - 07-07-2017
Fondly Remembered by
Wife: Mrs. Vimala Ramamurthi
Son: M.R. Vasudevan
D.in-law: Mrs. Vidhya Vasudevan
Grandson: M.V.Vishal Sundar
Grand D.in-law: Sharmada Venkatasubramanian
Friends & Relatives

12th Year Anniversary

A. SRINIVASAN
Fondly remembered by
Family & Friends
Sakthi Srinivasan Groups
Rice Wholesale Merchants

Your Love remains our guiding light

Mr. S. Chandra Mohan
(05-12-1949 - 07-07-2025)
Retired Administrative Officer
All India Radio / Doordarshan
lovingly remembered by:
Wife, Daughter, Son-in-law &
Grandchildren

SECOND YEAR ANNIVERSARY

B. MADANAMOHAN
(Retired Deputy collector)
01-09-1951 - 07-07-2024
You were the light of
our lives and will remain
in our hearts forever.
Fondly remembered by
Family members and friends.
9840027280

DEATH

DEEPLY MOURNED

Dr. KESANA RAVI

Attained eternity on
6th July 2026 at 11 AM

Funeral: 10.30 AM, 7th July 2026.

Your life was a blessing, your memory was a treasure
You are loved beyond words and missed beyond measure
You will forever remain in our hearts

PROPRIETOR - RAVIBALA ROADWAYS
MANAGING PARTNER - UMA SERVICE STATION
MANAGING DIRECTOR - RAKSHITH HOSPITAL

The family expresses sincere gratitude for
your prayers, love and support during this difficult time

EVER LOVING FAMILY

NO. 9, 1ST CROSS STREET, TRUSTPURAM, KODAMBAKKAM, CHENNAI - 600024. PH: 9600036399, 9445524466



Falling behind

Urbanisation in Mumbai is evolving faster than its infrastructure upgrades

The southwest monsoon has been highly active over western India, with south-westerly winds loaded with moisture sweeping over the Western Ghats and delivering intense rains along the Konkan coast, while other weather systems offshore are routing more moisture over Mumbai and the surrounding areas. In urban areas in general, rainfall intensity matters more than volume. Mumbai itself can generally absorb moderate rainfall over several hours; however, its drainage – like in many Indian cities – cannot handle several hundred millimetres in short bursts. Heavy rainfall also overwhelmed river catchments in parts of Maharashtra, including around Nashik, while high tides reduced the efficiency of Mumbai’s stormwater drainage, worsening flooding in the city. Mumbai-Pune rail services were suspended after landslides in the Bhor Ghat and flights were affected. The closures of the Mumbai-Pune expressway and the Mumbai-Goa highway and significant flooding on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad expressway were disruptive, speaking to the increasing erraticity of monsoon rainfall, the vulnerabilities associated with linear infrastructure projects, and the ease with which the effects of natural disasters are compounded by cascading failures. A chawl collapse in Mankhurd took the lives of five children.

Mumbai lies on a peninsula built mostly on reclaimed land, former marshes, tidal flats, and low-lying coastal areas, creating the characteristic risk of higher flooding when rainfall coincides with high tide. It is compounded by decades of haphazard urbanisation that has encouraged water to run-off rather than be absorbed by the ground, forcing drains to handle more water than their design limits. After the July 2005 floods, when it received 944 mm in 24 hours, Mumbai launched the BRIMSTOWAD project and widened drains, installed pumping stations, and undertook premonsoon de-silting. Many of these works remain incomplete while some completed upgrades are based on assumptions about the monsoon that climate change has since undermined. Officials have also argued that pre-monsoon desilting helped reduce flooding in parts of Mumbai, but water on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad expressway, the chawl collapse, deadly tree falls in Kurla and Aarey, lack of redundancies in public transport, and the BMC’s belated advisory to builders to halt hazardous construction all suggest a governance lapse. Mumbai’s accountability also remains split across the BMC for local drainage and roads, the IMD for forecasting, the NDRF, two Railway zones, the State government, and highway authorities. Overall, the city has improved at shutting down to save lives and minimising the death toll – but as climate change and urbanisation evolve faster than infrastructure upgrades, simply waiting for system capacity to catch up to demand will be a failing strategy.

Bad for both

Russia and Ukraine must end the war and concede mutual concessions

More than four years into Russia’s invasion, Ukraine has found ways to raise the cost of the war for the Kremlin – striking its energy infrastructure with drones and imposing a drone blockade on Crimea. When the war began in February 2022, Ukraine’s immediate response was to resist Russia’s battlefield advances, while mobilising international support. As the war dragged on, Ukraine received advanced defensive and offensive weapons from its western partners, while Russia was subjected to sweeping sanctions. But this approach did not slow Russia, which reinforced its front lines and captured more Ukrainian territory. Both sides have suffered tens of thousands of casualties. Ukraine’s economy has become heavily dependent on western aid. Kyiv has also transformed the way the war is fought by launching hundreds of drones each day at Russian troops and critical infrastructure. For President Vladimir Putin, who initially sought to shield the Russian public from the consequences of the war, these attacks are a stark reminder that the war has come home. Strikes on Russian oil facilities, described by Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy as “long-range sanctions”, have knocked out parts of Russia’s refining capacity. Ukraine has also targeted the electricity infrastructure and fuel logistics of Crimea, the Black Sea peninsula Russia annexed in 2014, forcing a state of emergency.

Mr. Zelenskyy wants to use this offensive pressure to force Mr. Putin to the negotiating table and secure a ceasefire. But drone warfare has only slowed Russian advances. Last week, Russia’s Defence Ministry announced the capture of the eastern city of Kostiantynivka and a closing in on Lyman. Russia now controls over 20% of Ukraine since 2014. Russia has repeatedly accused NATO countries of enabling Ukraine to strike deep inside its territory. Mr. Putin is already under pressure over his inability to secure a decisive victory, and nationalist voices have urged him to widen the conflict to increase pressure on NATO. The situation remains highly volatile with no political settlement in sight. Ukraine can hurt Russia economically, but it continues to lose ground on the battlefield. Russia can inflict military losses on Ukraine, but it is also facing attacks on a scale unseen since the Second World War. Neither side has a viable military path to achieving its objectives. Mr. Putin and Mr. Zelenskyy should adopt a more accommodative position with mutual concessions. They should agree to a ceasefire and be ready to begin substantive negotiations on the outstanding issues, including the security concerns of both countries and the future of NATO.

Recently, a Congress leader revived an old constitutional debate by demanding that voting should be recognised as a fundamental right. At first sight, the demand appears unexceptionable. In a democracy, what could be more fundamental than a citizen’s right to choose those who govern? Yet, for more than seven decades, the Supreme Court of India has consistently held that the right to vote is not a fundamental right but merely a statutory right.

This judicial position, though well established, has become increasingly difficult to reconcile with the Court’s own evolving jurisprudence. In a series of landmark decisions, the Court has gradually transformed the voter from a passive statutory creature into an active constitutional actor.

The result is a curious paradox: while the act of voting itself continues to be described as statutory, many of its essential facets have already acquired constitutional protection.

The traditional position dates back to *N.P. Ponnuswami vs Returning Officer* (1952), where the Court held that the right to vote and the right to contest elections are not common law rights but rights created by statute. The principle was reaffirmed in *Jyoti Basu & Others vs Debi Ghosal & Others* (1982), where Justice O. Chinnappa Reddy observed that the right to elect, “fundamental though it is to democracy”, is neither a fundamental right nor a common law right, but “purely a statutory right”. A Constitution Bench reiterated this position in *Kuldip Nayar vs Union of India* (2006), holding that while democracy forms part of the basic structure of the Constitution, the individual right to vote flows from legislation, principally the Representation of the People Acts.

The logic behind this approach is understandable. The Constitution does not expressly enumerate the right to vote among the fundamental rights contained in Part III. Parliament, therefore, enjoys considerable latitude in prescribing qualifications, disqualifications and procedures governing elections.

However, the story does not end there.

Constitutionalising the poll process

Beginning in the early years of this century, the Court embarked upon a process of constitutionalising the electoral process. In *Union of India vs Association for Democratic Reforms* (2002), the Court held that voters have a right to know the criminal antecedents, educational qualifications and financial assets of candidates. This right was located squarely in Article 19(1)(a), the fundamental right to freedom of speech and expression. The Court reasoned that meaningful participation in democracy is impossible unless voters are adequately informed.



S.Y. Quraishi

Former Chief Election Commissioner of India and author of ‘An Undocumented Wonder: The Making of the Great Indian Election’

The right not to vote enjoys constitutional protection; paradoxically, the right to vote does not

A year later, in *People’s Union of Civil Liberties vs Union of India* (2003), the Court drew an important distinction. While reiterating that the right to vote is statutory, it held that the freedom of voting – that is, the freedom to make an informed choice – is a fundamental right protected by Article 19(1)(a).

The most intriguing development came in the 2013 *NOTA* judgment. Recognising the option of “None of the Above”, the Court held that a voter’s decision to reject all candidates is a form of political expression protected by Article 19(1)(a). The Court further held that secrecy of the ballot must extend even to those who choose not to vote for any candidate.

This produces an extraordinary constitutional anomaly. The Court has effectively held that the right to know is fundamental, the freedom to make an informed choice is fundamental, the secrecy of the ballot is fundamental, and even the right to reject all candidates is constitutionally protected. Yet, the act of voting itself continues to be treated as a mere statutory entitlement.

One is tempted to ask: if the Constitution protects the right to reject all candidates, why does it not protect the right to choose one?

Recent constitutional jurisprudence also points in this direction. In *Anoop Baranwal vs Union of India* (2023), Justice Ajay Rastogi, in his separate opinion, expressly favoured recognising voting as a fundamental right. Although this view did not command a majority, the Constitution Bench repeatedly referred to voting as a constitutional right rather than merely a statutory one. This marks an important shift in judicial understanding. The Court may not yet have elevated voting to the status of a fundamental right, but it has undoubtedly moved beyond the narrow statutory conception that dominated earlier decisions.

The anomaly becomes even more striking when viewed through the prism of the basic structure doctrine. Since *Kesavananda Bharati vs State of Kerala* (1973), the Court has repeatedly held that democracy forms part of the Constitution’s basic structure. In *Indira Nehru Gandhi vs Shri Raj Narain & Anr.* (1975), the Court underscored that free and fair elections are an essential feature of democracy. Subsequent decisions have consistently reaffirmed this principle.

Democracy begins with votes

But democracy does not exist in the abstract. It operates through elections, and elections derive their legitimacy from the participation of citizens through the ballot. The vote is the very instrument through which popular sovereignty is exercised. It is through the vote that “We, the People” periodically renew the legitimacy of the state and hold governments accountable.

If democracy is a part of the Constitution’s

basic structure, and if free and fair elections are indispensable to democracy, it is difficult to explain why the citizen’s right to vote should remain outside the constitutional core. To say that democracy is basic to the Constitution while the citizen’s vote is merely a statutory right appears incongruous. A democracy without voters is inconceivable.

This does not necessarily mean that every aspect of voting should be elevated into an absolute fundamental right immune from regulation. Parliament must continue to prescribe qualifications, disqualifications and procedures necessary for the conduct of elections. Age requirements, electoral rolls, residency conditions, disqualifications for corrupt practices and other regulatory provisions are indispensable for orderly elections.

What requires constitutional recognition is not every procedural detail but the core right of every eligible citizen to participate in the democratic process.

This becomes particularly evident when one examines Article 326 of the Constitution. The Article mandates that elections to the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies shall be based on universal adult suffrage. Every citizen above the age of 18 is constitutionally entitled to be registered as an elector, subject only to narrowly defined disqualifications. The source of this entitlement is not legislation but the Constitution itself. The Representation of the People Acts merely operationalise that constitutional command.

Thus, while the mechanics of voting may be statutory, the citizen’s entitlement to be a voter flows directly from the Constitution. Exclusion from the electoral roll, except in accordance with constitutionally permissible limitations, therefore, strikes at a constitutional guarantee.

A matter for the Court to revisit

The distinction between statutory and constitutional rights may have served a useful purpose in the early years of the Republic, when electoral jurisprudence was still in its infancy. But the Court’s own decisions have steadily blurred that distinction by progressively constitutionalising various facets of voting.

Perhaps the time has come for the Court to revisit an old doctrine. In a Constitution where democracy and free and fair elections constitute the basic structure, the citizen’s vote cannot remain a constitutional orphan. The ballot is not merely a statutory privilege conferred by Parliament. It is the instrument through which popular sovereignty is expressed and the Republic periodically renews its democratic legitimacy.

After all, if the Constitution protects the right to reject every candidate, it can scarcely deny protection to the right to choose one.

AI governance and a voice for the Global South

In February 2026, India hosted the India AI Impact Summit 2026, that sought to put the needs and challenges of the Global South at the centre of the Artificial Intelligence (AI) discourse. The summit’s themes framed by India were rooted in the contextual realities of the Global South with a focus on real-world harms. This was a departure from the previous summits (at Bletchley Park, 2023, U.K.; Seoul 2024, and Paris 2025) that prioritised both catastrophic and existential risks over questions of present harms, equity and inclusion.

As the Summit evolved, the political and policy momentum shifted toward raising capital for AI development in India and accelerating adoption through domestic use cases. In this process, India increasingly began to position itself within the newly framed “middle power” discourse, at the cost of Global South solidarity which underpinned the Summit’s original vision. India clarified this stance by joining Pax Silica, signalling strategic alignment with the United States-dominated semiconductor supply chain. As part of the agreement, India agreed to adopt a pro-innovation regulatory approach, thereby compromising its pursuit of strategic autonomy.

Middle power dilemma

This repositioning of India’s geopolitical character, as a middle power, has left it in a lonely corner. The middle power narrative is diplomatically attractive but strategically uneasy. India’s aspirations to be positioned alongside European and Asian countries such as Japan, which do not consider India a peer in technological capability or economic development, is also in dissonance with its colonial past and low per capita – realities that firmly anchor India within the Global South.

Accompanying the friction between India’s ambition and its realities is the U.S.’s foreign policy push for global AI adoption of U.S. tech, bringing into question whether it will be a reliable



Jhalak M. Kakkar

Executive Director, Centre for Communication Governance, National Law University Delhi



Astha Kapoor

Co-founder and Director of the AapTI Institute

India faces a choice between dependency and leadership in AI governance

partner in the AI adventure to India. The U.S. has declared its disinterest in AI governance, especially global multilateral or multistakeholder governance. This raises fundamental questions for India and the Global South on concentration of infrastructure, and economic power in the U.S. Will this be a repeat of the social media story – when U.S. foreign policy pushed back against regulating for user harms to safeguard the interests of social media platforms concentrated in the U.S.? Furthermore, economic value primarily accrues to American industry despite significant business and users outside its borders, while disproportionate externalities and harms also persist in domestic markets.

Pertinent issues

In the AI story, numerous questions arise. Will India mainly be a consumer of U.S. tech with Indian users bearing disproportionate harm? Will India be a site for extraction of data, labour for data labelling, minerals for manufacturing, and land, water, electricity and resources for data centres, primarily enabling the growth of American Big Tech?

Since the summit in February, India has sanctioned land for data centres displacing communities, triggering protests. There are no meaningful guardrails to protect local communities as American companies scrape public content to build language and indigenous knowledge datasets. The non-profit ecosystem is signing memoranda of understanding to diffuse AI and adopt use cases. However, fundamental AI innovation has been slow – India remains unable to compete with global foundational models, its semiconductor development is focused on low-value assembly and there is a question of adequate capital to invest and grow the national AI ecosystem.

But perhaps all is not lost for India. The first of a two-part UN Global Dialogue on AI is underway in Geneva (July 6-7, 2026). Stakeholders will

convene to discuss how the multilateral and multistakeholder ecosystem can come together to collectively define the rules for the governance of AI.

A window for leadership

India can use the opportunity to stitch together a fractured AI policy agenda that currently lacks a leader. It remains one of the few countries with the political heft, the technical capacity, and a diverse market to play this role. Rather than positioning itself merely as a destination for investment or a market for AI, India could reassert a vision of technological development rooted in public purpose, user safety, strategic autonomy, and international cooperation.

India should reiterate the need for international norms that empower Global South countries to focus on building local AI ecosystems and fostering innovation, safeguarding users, enhancing regulatory capacity, enabling skilling and developing domestic infrastructure. It should also advance critical debates on competition and consumer protection and ensure economic value accrues within national markets.

Concurrently, India must create pathways for international cooperation on AI within the Global South. The Geneva dialogue is a critical moment for Global South countries to come together to enable enhanced agency and strategic autonomy.

This requires developing innovative approaches to pool capacity and resources including cooperation on data, compute, interoperable standards and shared protocols and governance, and strengthening institutional capacity both regulatory and technical across the Global South.

As heterogeneous as the Global South is, it can be a counterweight to the hegemony of Big Tech. India can lead this march to ensure that shared governance norms are created and benefits are shared with the people in the Global South, appropriately protecting them from harm.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Notice to Meta

The Union government’s decision to issue a notice to Meta over advertisements allegedly linked to child sexual abuse material deserves unequivocal public attention (Front page, July 6). Digital platforms that wield unprecedented influence over the dissemination of information cannot evade

responsibility when their advertising ecosystems become conduits for content that exploits or endangers children. While technological complexity may make absolute prevention difficult, it cannot serve as a convenient alibi for regulatory complacency or corporate indifference. This episode should serve

as a reminder that the digital public sphere is not exempt from ethical accountability. **Nagarajamani M.V.**, Hyderabad

Urban failures

The “resilient city” is becoming a myth – when drainage networks are consistently overwhelmed, it is not an act of god; it is a

failure of foresight. If our cities cannot survive the monsoon, our investments in high-speed connectivity will prove to be expensive mistakes. We must prioritise sustainable, climate-proof infrastructure in India before the next deluge causes irreversible damage to our urban centres. **Sneha Shree K.**, Hyderabad

Celebrating 250

The United States has just celebrated its semiquincentennial against the backdrop of deep ideological, economic, and political rifts. The milestone highlights an ongoing debate over the country’s identity, with differing visions for what America represents. While the 1976 Bicentennial occurred amid

the fallout of Vietnam and Watergate, the current deep-seated polarisation is rooted in a fundamental clash over basic historical truths, election integrity, and economic realities. **R. Sivakumar**, Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address and the full name.

How the right to walk is integral to modernity

That we would need a court of law to remind us that the Right to Walk should be a fundamental right at this moment in history when activists are trying to stop government-corporations from restricting the natural flow of rivers cannot be just a coincidence. The Right to Walk on footpaths, to be specific. There is a restriction on the freedom of nearly all parts of the human body imposed by the state – the hands cannot touch whatever they want to, one can’t spit or defecate wherever one might want to, one cannot rest one’s back against every available wall, and our legs are prevented from taking us to anywhere the mind wants to.

Hence the unnoticed privilege of having a mind – “*Kothao aamar hariye jawar nei mana monay monay*” (I can get lost anywhere, in my mind), is a Rabindranath song sung as much with hope as with the intuitive acknowledgement that only the mind has that kind of unrestricted freedom. At the other end of the head are our legs, and one would imagine that they would also like a similar degree of freedom as the mind has in the Tagore song. It must be in acknowledgement of this need that the Supreme Court has asked for the Right to Walk on footpaths to be included as a fundamental right.

Walking with(in) literature
It seems almost tautological – the need for such a right. However, under a Facebook post from a decade ago, which detailed the experience of being a pedestrian in India, among the many disrespectful and inhuman responses was one by a young engineer. The pedestrian does not pay road tax and therefore cannot make a claim on the road, he said. The abrasive character of new capitalist energy soon became visible; he insisted that like the poor, the pedestrian was a burden on the Indian economy. What would he then make of the recent Supreme Court ruling that



Sumana Roy
teaches at Ashoka University, Sonipat, and is the author of ‘How I Became a Tree’ and ‘Provincials’

Even the gods had a history of walking: the goddess Lakshmi’s footprints, drawn as part of folk rituals of worship, are evidence of that

declared the Right to Walk safely on footpaths a fundamental right under Article 19(1)(d) (freedom of movement) and Article 21 (right to life), a ruling that gives pedestrians a claim on public pathways over automobiles?

Five kilometres away from the Supreme Court, where this ruling was given, Gandhi was walking, his walk frozen into a statue along with others in the piece of sculpture called “Gyarah Murti”, built by Devi Prasad Roy Chowdhury. Could that have played a role in the ruling? Or, since they knew the Indian Constitution so well, could they have been unconsciously thinking of Nandalal Bose, whose art frames the words that guarantees our relationship with this country, and whose linocut from 1930, “Bapuji”, which showcases Gandhi standing with the most well-known walking stick in the world, has conditioned the way we imagine Gandhi? Or could they have been thinking of Rabindranath’s song “*Aekla chalo re*” (Walk alone), which sings of the conviction necessary to walk alone?

The judges who had delivered this judgment, Justices P.S. Narasimha and A.S. Chandurkar, must have been raised by a literary consciousness that would have influenced such an outlook. To give an example, a poem such as Jibanananda Das’s *Bonolata Sen*, that begins, ‘For a thousand years I’ve been walking earth’s paths,/from Sinhala’s seas to the waters of Malaya in night’s darkness’. A poem like that was in the air, and influenced the way a community spoke and loved and laughed. There were bound to be equivalents of this trust placed in walking in all literary and artistic cultures of India.

Walking has been integral to the creation of a political instinct in India – from Subhash Chandra Bose’s ‘Delhi chalo’ to Gandhi’s Dandi March, various protest marches have marked resistance before and after 1947. These had been sharpened by a spiritual

history that had been a harvest of walking – by figures such as Siddhartha, Nanak, Chaitanya, and other mendicant-seekers. Even the gods had a history of walking: the goddess Lakshmi’s footprints, drawn as part of folk rituals of worship, are evidence of that. As had ways of storing information or writing a poem or telling a story, for, ‘*pada*’ (foot), is a metric stanza and also a foundational group in Indic knowledge categories.

A symbol of modernity
At university, the author of this article had once told her teacher that modernity came to exist because Baudelaire – who coined the term in his 1863 essay “The Painter of Modern Life” – walked the streets of Paris. One wasn’t thinking specifically of the flaneur, but of walking without purpose, and what it does to our mind and its circulation of thoughts. We’ve all benefitted from walking unknotting the clots in our self-accusatory consciousness.

“The long poem of walking manipulates spatial organisations, no matter how panoptic they may be: it is neither foreign to them (it can take place only within them) nor in conformity with them (it does not receive its identity from them). It creates shadows and ambiguities within them. It inserts its multitudinous references and citations into them (social models, cultural mores, personal factors). Within them it is itself the effect of successive encounters and occasions that constantly alter it and make it the other’s blazon: in other words, it is like a peddler carrying something surprising, transverse or attractive compared with the usual choice. These diverse aspects provide the basis of a rhetoric. They can even be said to define it,” Michel de Certeau writes in *The Practice of Everyday Life*. The Supreme Court’s judgment, in rehabilitating the sense of life as a long poem, to “wander lonely as a cloud”, restores to Indians their quiet modernity.

A defection wave in Tamil Nadu

The switch-over of AIADMK MLAs is evidence of a deeper shift in the State’s politics

STATE OF PLAY

B. Kolappan

Tamil Nadu is witnessing an unusual political phenomenon ever since the Tamilaga Vetri Kazhagam (TVK), led by actor-turned-politician C. Joseph Vijay, came to power. Several MLAs, most of them from the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK), have resigned their hard-won Assembly seats to join the ruling party, hoping to be renominated by the TVK in the ensuing by-elections. Before their switch over, as many as 25 MLAs even voted in favour of the TVK government during the Assembly floor test.

Although the TVK emerged as the single largest party in the Assembly, it fell short of a majority by 10 seats. It eventually formed the government after the Congress switched allegiance from the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK)-led camp, while the two communist parties and the Viduthala Chiruthaigal Katchi initially extended outside support. The have now joined the government along with the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML). The ruling party, however, does not appear content with a working majority. Instead, it seems intent on strengthening its own numbers so that it need not depend on allies for its survival.

A trend reversal
The continuing stream of resignations and defections has been described by the Opposition as “horse trading” – a phenomenon largely unfamiliar to Tamil Nadu politics. So far, six AIADMK legislators have quit and joined the TVK. Governments in the State have traditionally enjoyed comfor-



table legislative majorities and, even when they fell short of the required numbers, have generally refrained from encouraging defections to secure their position.

The trend began with the shift in loyalty of S. Kamaraj, an MLA of the Amma Makkal Munnetra Kazhagam (AMMK) led by T. T. V. Dhinakaran. When Chief Minister-designate Mr. Vijay presented to Governor Rajendra Arlekar a letter of support purportedly signed by Mr. Kamaraj, Mr. Dhinakaran alleged that the document had been forged. The allegation, however, was soon disproved when Mr. Kamaraj voted in favour of the government during the confidence motion. He was then expelled from the AMMK.

What surprised political observers even more was the defection of MLAs from the AIADMK, a party that ruled Tamil Nadu for decades under towering leaders such as M. G. Ramachandran and Jayalalithaa. Within days of the election results, three MLAs – Maragatham Kumaravel, S. Jayakumar and P. Sathyabama – met Speaker J. C. D. Prabhakar and submitted their resignation letters. They were followed by Esakki Subaya. All of them joined the TVK right after.

More striking, however, was the decision of senior AIADMK leaders and former Ministers, including C. Vijaya-baskar, M. R. Vijayabaskar and

Udumalai K. Radhakrishnan (former MLA), to cross over to the ruling party. While they blamed former Chief Minister and AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami for their decision, their actions suggest a broader political calculation. They appear to have concluded that the bipolar political order that long defined Tamil Nadu – dominated by the AIADMK and the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) – has come to an end with the rise of the TVK, and that an AIADMK bereft of a charismatic leader has little prospect of regaining power.

Counter allegations
As the trend continued, the DMK accused the TVK of inducing two of its MLAs – S. Austin and Anbazhagan – to resign their seats and join the ruling party. The allegation came close on the heels of the TVK’s charge that former Minister V. Senthilbalaji had attempted to lure its MLA N. Elaiyaraja with an offer of ₹35 crore. The police subsequently arrested a few persons in connection with the TVK’s complaint. The DMK also alleged that the TVK had sought to persuade two MLAs (who contested on its symbol), originally from the Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, to resign and recontest.

The spate of resignations, which began barely 20 days after the formation of the new government, evoked strong reactions from the communist parties. They described the developments as an unhealthy trend that could undermine democratic norms. Yet they appear to have little influence over the unfolding events, watching helplessly as the political drama continues to play out day after day.

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Questions surrounding the Quad’s future

With the U.S. reversing the U.S. Indo-Pacific Command back to the U.S. Pacific Command, criticisms have been levelled against the relevance of the Quad

DATA POINT

Amit Kumar

Last week, Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi was in New Delhi for the 16th India-Japan Annual Summit, her first visit to India since assuming office. The two sides reaffirmed their commitment to a free and open Indo-Pacific. The reaffirmation, however, comes at a moment when the idea of the Indo-Pacific appears to be losing its principal champion. On June 16, the Pentagon renamed the U.S. Indo-Pacific Command back to the U.S. Pacific Command, reversing a change it had made in 2018.

The renaming of the Command in 2018, although symbolic, recognised the region’s growing significance and acknowledged India’s centrality to the U.S.’s regional strategy. The reversal suggests that the region no longer enjoys the priority it once did in Washington. In fact, the National Security Strategy released by the U.S. in November 2025 prioritises the Western Hemisphere over the Indo-Pacific and mentions the Quad only in passing. It also assuages Beijing, which has long resented the formulation. Washington’s approach to managing its relations with Beijing is undergoing a change under the current administration.

All of this has put the future of the Quad under the scanner. If Washington retreats from the idea, the platform built around it inevitably invites questions about its relevance. These anxieties only add to a set of older concerns. How relevant or securitised is the Quad? Is it doing enough? And the criticisms aren’t without substance.

The first criticism entails the hesitation to name China. If the objective is indeed to shape the balance of power in the region, the silence over Beijing’s military and economic aggression is bad optics. However, this is largely a normative criticism. One can argue that

the Quad’s reluctance to name Beijing is strategic, because positioning itself as an anti-China platform could dissuade smaller countries from associating with it.

Critics highlight the Quad’s hesitation to project itself as a security-centric grouping as another of its shortcomings. Given that Beijing poses hard security challenges to the region, any balancing effort has to be primarily security-centric. The extent of the grouping’s hesitation is evident in the members’ active effort to make an implicit distinction between Quad and the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (QSD). There is a reluctance to use them interchangeably, even as the members acknowledge the grouping’s origins to be rooted in the first QSD in 2004.

The Quad’s reluctance to elevate the partnership to a 2+2 format – a bilateral ministerial dialogue comprising Foreign and Defence Ministers – is another pain point. Even as each of the four countries has formalised 2+2 meetings bilaterally with one another, the Quad continues to host meetings only at the leaders’ and Foreign Ministers’ level.

Domain of cooperation

The alleged overwhelming focus on non-security or soft issues is a related criticism. However, a review of the Quad’s agenda tells a different story. Even though the Quad assumed its current form in 2017, there was a lull for the first four years. It only picked up steam in 2021 during the COVID-19 pandemic, when the four countries held their first virtual leaders’ summit and announced a first set of initiatives. Within six months, the Quad held its first in-person leaders’ summit and expanded its areas of cooperation. The list today has grown to 37, of which 23 fall under security-related domains (**Chart 1**). Technology sovereignty, maritime capabilities and secure communications will be key in countering China in the years ahead.

Choosing the right areas of cooperation doesn’t necessarily reveal much, though. The type of cooperation and capital flows are key determinants in evaluating the seriousness of the grouping. But a review of the ‘type’ of cooperation in security-related domains suggests that Quad has a heavy focus on interoperability, data sharing, monitoring, and relief (**Chart 2**). While this is necessary and critically important for any security-focused grouping, Quad’s integration efforts are limited to civilian or non-military grade applications. Nonetheless, these integration exercises have dual-use capabilities and can be leveraged for even military-grade purposes.

The Quad’s focus on building capacity and resilient supply chains is also significant, especially as these relate to critical and emerging technologies, maritime, and communications – the domains where the bulk of contestation with China is expected.

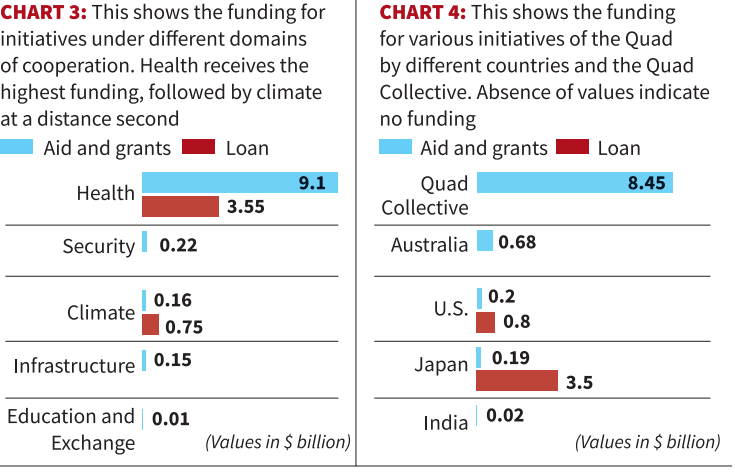
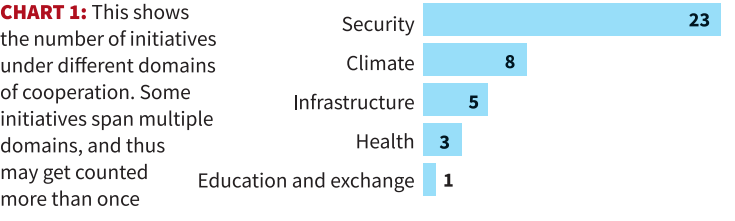
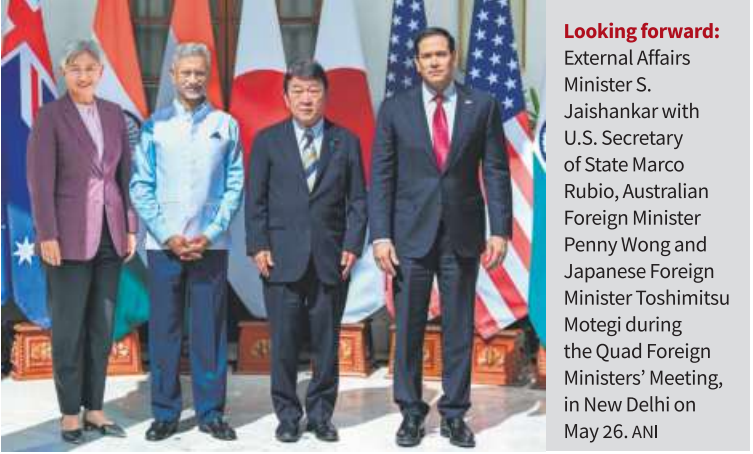
The Quad’s security focus is not matched by its funding pattern. Based on what is available in the public domain, health and climate have been the primary beneficiaries (**Chart 3**). One can argue that since most security-related initiatives focus on integration and standard-setting, they do not require the same scale of dedicated funding. But building resilient supply chains would require substantial capital commitment, and that is where the gap is most visible.

The Quad’s recent commitment to mobilise \$20 billion towards the Critical Minerals Initiative and Framework could change this picture. But it remains only a stated target at this point, with no funding committed or allocated. If security issues make up close to two-thirds of Quad’s initiatives, the funding allocation must follow suit.

The questions surrounding the Quad’s future will not be settled by nomenclature in Washington. They will be settled by whether the grouping backs its security-heavy agenda with capital.

Uncertain course

Amit Kumar is a Staff Research Analyst with the Geostrategy Programme at The Takshashila Institution. The data for the charts were sourced by the author from his Quad Monitor dashboard



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO JULY 7, 1976

Unauthorised accounts in foreign banks

New Delhi, July 6: Seventy bank accounts maintained abroad by Indian citizens resident in India without the permission of the Reserve Bank of India have been detected by the Enforcement Directorate during the first five months of the current calendar year, according to an official press release.

The total balances in the detected bank accounts when converted into Indian rupees, amount to Rs. 73.16 lakhs. The offenders include businessmen, doctors, and advocates.

The balances held in foreign currency abroad are 2,49,116 pound sterling, 92,283 U.S. dollars, 26,723 Malaysian dollars, 30,000 East African shilling, 1,94,347 Swiss francs, 15,500 Lira and 22,000 Australian dollars.

The Enforcement Directorate conducted during May 198 searches and seized foreign and Indian currencies valued at Rs. 1.48 lakhs.

Adjudication proceedings were started in 658 cases during the month and of this 486 cases were adjudicated under the Foreign Exchange Regulation Act and penalties amounting to Rs. 16.23 lakhs were imposed, besides confiscation of foreign and Indian currencies amounting to Rs. 425 lakhs. The Directorate also secured conviction in 10 cases.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JULY 7, 1926

£45,000 paid for old Bible

Dia Reichspost Vienna, reports the sale of a well-preserved copy of the three volume Gutenberg Bible by the Benedictine Convent of Saint Pail, near Klagenfurt, in Carinthia, to an American dealer, for 1,500,000 Austrian shillings (about £45,000), with official permission. All bibliophiles will wait with breathless interest for further news, and particularly for the name of the American dealer. It is an open secret that Mr. Edward Goldston, of Bloomsbury, London, who recently sold another Gutenberg Bible to America for £21,800 had been in negotiation for the treasure now reported sold. He made a special journey to Austria some months ago, and opened negotiations with the Benedictine Convent. The prices of £60,000 was asked, Mr. Goldston regarded this as ridiculous, and Dr. Rosenbach, the American bibliophile, who saw him in London some time after agreed with him.

		BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION Office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division, Bommanahalli Zone-2, HSR Layout, BDA Complex, Bengaluru-560102	
		No.: EE/HSR-D/TEND/PR/11/2026-27	
		Date: 04.07.2026	
CORRIGENDUM-1			
Ref: 1. BSCC/EE/HSR-D/TEND-06/2026-27, Date: 01.06.2026			
With reference to the above tender notification due to technical issue in force there is few modification in the said notification as mentioned in the below table,			
Sl. No.	As per Tender Notification / Tender Document	To be Read as	
1	Tender documents can be down loaded from through website https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in from 02.07.2026 .	Tender documents can be down loaded from through website https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in from 07.07.2026 .	
2	Pre-bid meeting will be held on 06.07.2026 at 11:00 a.m. in the office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division, Begur Main Road, Bengaluru-560068	Pre-bid meeting will be held on 10.07.2026 at 11:00 a.m. in the office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division, Begur Main Road, Bengaluru-560068	
3	Last date for submission of tender documents on or before 11.07.2026 at 4:00 p.m.	Last date for submission of tender documents on or before 14.07.2026 at 4:00 p.m.	
4	Technical Bids will be opened on the website https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in in the office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division on 13.07.2026 at 4:30 p.m. onwards	Technical Bids will be opened on the website https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in in the office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division on 15.07.2026 at 4:30 p.m. onwards	
Other than this everything remains unaltered.			
Sd/- Executive Engineer, HSR Division, Bengaluru South City Corporation			

Business

INBRIEF



Rupee falls 25 paise against U.S. dollar, closes at 95.43

The rupee depreciated 25 paise to close at 95.43 against the U.S. dollar on Monday, as a strengthening greenback weighed on emerging market currencies. At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.25 against the American currency and traded in a range of 95.22-95.48 during the session. The rupee finally closed at 95.43, down 25 paise from its previous close. [FTI](#)

NSE targets to launch ₹30,000-cr. IPO in September

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) is targeting to launch its much-awaited initial public offering (IPO), estimated at around ₹30,000 crore, in September, people familiar with the development said on Monday. The mega IPO is expected to value the country's largest stock exchange at over ₹5 lakh crore. The exchange will soon begin roadshows for the IPO. If successful, the issue will surpass Hyundai Motor India's ₹27,870-crore IPO launched in October 2024. [FTI](#)

Granules secures FTF status for CNS depressant generic

Granules India has secured sole first-to-file (FTF) status for its abbreviated new drug application (ANDA) for Sodium Oxybate extended-release for oral suspension, the generic equivalent of Lumryz ER oral suspension of Alkermes plc. This is Granules' second sole FTF ANDA. LUMRYZ (sodium oxybate) ER oral suspension is indicated in the U.S. for the treatment of excessive daytime sleepiness in patients with narcolepsy.



The BSE logo at the entrance of the building in Mumbai.

Markets rise for fourth straight session

Ashokamithran T
MUMBAI

Benchmarks Nifty 50 and BSE Sensex traded positively for the fourth straight session with the indices improving almost 0.7% each to 78,285.07 and 24,430.35 on Monday.

The last time the indices rose for straight sessions was between June 12 and June 18 when investors were upbeat for five consecutive days. However, this four-day rally is weaker than the previous one as on all the four days, the rise was not more than 0.7%. On the other hand, the June instance began with the first day closing 2% higher and the second day almost 1% over the previous close.

Despite the winning streak, 1,700 of the 3,400 stocks that traded declined on Monday. However, most of the sectoral indices delivered positive returns with just four of the 21 indices, declining.

“The index continues to trade comfortably above previous week's high and 20- and 50-day EMAs (exponential moving average, an indicator used to track a stock's price trend over a period), highlighting sustained strength,” said Bajaj Broking Research team.



Auto retail sales up 22% to 25.57 lakh units

Landmark June for automobile segment with two-wheelers, three-wheelers, commercial vehicles, passenger vehicles and overall registrations posting their highest-ever June figures, says FADA president; share of alternative-fuel passenger vehicles crosses 40% for the first time

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The automobile sector retailed 25,57,234 units in June 2026, a 21.83% year-on-year (YoY) growth and a 1.03% increase over the previous month. The passenger vehicles (PV) segment registered a 28.63% growth, followed by tractors at 25.31%, two-wheelers (2W) 21.22%, commercial vehicles (CV) 16.88% and three-wheelers (3W) at 16.20%.

However, the wheeled construction equipment segment registered a 40.94% YoY decline on a high base, according to da-

ta released by the Federation of Automobile Dealers Association (FADA) on Monday. “June 2026 has been a landmark month for Indian auto retail with two-wheelers, three-wheelers, commercial vehicles, passenger vehicles and overall registrations posting their highest-ever June figures,” said FADA president C.S. Vigneshwar.

Tractor retail sales stood at 1,00,818 units, a growth of 25.31% YoY and 21.33% MoM.

“Tractors recorded their second-best June ever. That such records have come in a seasonally transitional month underscores the structural depth



Shifting gear: Tractor retail sales stood at 1,00,818 units, a growth of 25.31% year on year and 21.33% month on month. AFP

of the India growth story and the widening aspirations of Bharat,” he added. Two-wheeler retail sales stood at 18,28,458 units, up

21.22% YoY – the best June ever – though marginally lower by 0.89% month on month (MoM).

The urban two-wheeler

segment grew 4.25% MoM, while rural sales declined 4.55% MoM, reflecting the late onset and uneven progress of the south-west monsoon, which kept rain-fed markets in a wait-and-watch mode.

Commercial vehicle retails were at 90,972 units, a 16.88% YoY growth and the best June on record for the segment. Light commercial vehicles (LCVs) grew 21.10% YoY, medium commercial vehicles 16.81% and heavy commercial vehicles at 8.26%.

Dealers cited steady freight activity, e-commerce-linked movement and normalising supplies.

Share of commercial

electric vehicles (EVs) rose to an all-time high of 3.53% from 1.57% a year ago.

Passenger vehicle retail sales stood at 4,10,853 units, a growth of 28.63% YoY and 2.05% MoM.

Share of alternative-fuel PVs – CNG, Hybrid and EV combined – crossed the 40% mark for the first time, at 40.35% (CNG 24.33%, Hybrid 8.27%, EV 7.75%).

Passenger EV retail sales stood at an all-time high of 31,823 units.

The total EV retail sales across categories touched 3,06,220 units – the highest for any month – taking the overall EV penetration to about 12.5%.

SEBI said to ease short stocks by nearly doubling those eligible for borrowing

Reuters
MUMBAI

India's markets regulator aims to make it easier for investors to short stocks by nearly doubling the number of shares eligible for lending and borrowing and by cutting collateral requirements, two people with direct knowledge of the plans said.

The changes are aimed at boosting the cash equities market and drawing investors away from the country's far larger derivatives market, which has

The changes are aimed at drawing investors away from the far larger derivatives market

seen explosive growth but carries far larger risks for retail investors in particular.

Stock scam scandals led India to develop strict requirements for its cash equities market, with rules tightened in the early 2000s and then again in the period 2017 to 2020.

That has meant that while the National Stock Exchange, which accounts for about 95% of India's cash equities market, has some 2,600 companies listed, only 176 are currently eligible for borrowing and lending.

By nearly doubling that number, Indian authorities hope to include the majority of liquid shares, the people said.

The three main criteria determining eligibility include liquidity, trading volume and the stock's ability to support exposure to de-

rivatives trading.

For example, a stock must have an average monthly trading turnover of at least ₹1 billion (\$10.5 million) over the previous six months and be large enough to support derivatives exposure of at least ₹1 billion across the market. There are also rules relating to how much of a stock should be held by public shareholders.

“Deliberations are on relaxing the two thresholds,” said one of the people, without specifying which thresholds.

Manipal eyes ₹8,000-cr. IPO

Manipal Health Enterprises Ltd. received SEBI's approval to raise funds via an initial public offering (IPO) comprising fresh issue of shares worth ₹8,000 crore, an update with the markets regulator showed

KANNUR INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED
Kannur International Airport

E-Tender – Airport Restaurant
E-tenders are invited by Managing Director, KIAL for Selection of an Agency for Setting Up, Operating & Managing Airport Restaurant at City Side at Kannur International Airport.

For more details, please visit – www.etenders.kerala.gov.in
Bid Submission Last Date : 20 July 2026, 1400 Hrs
E-Tender ID: 2026_KIAL_849927_2

APPOINTMENT

V.O.Chidambaranar Port Authority
General Administration Department, Tuticorin
(An Autonomous Body under MoPSW, GoI)

No.GAD-EST10ESTC(EST)/29/2024-GAD-Part(1)(7358)/D
Date: 07.07.2026
Advertisement for Engagement of Professional Interns on Contractual basis
V.O.Chidambaranar Port Authority invites applications for the following positions on contractual basis:-

Sl. No.	Name of the Position	No. of Positions	Consolidated monthly remuneration
1.	Professional Intern (Stenography)	03	Rs. 30,000/-
2.	Professional Intern (Legal)	02	

For experience, educational qualification and other details, visit VOC Port's website at www.vocport.gov.in (careers). Last date for the receipt of application is 06.08.2026.
Sd/- Secretary

ANDHRA PRADESH POWER UTILITIES
RECRUITMENT FOR THE POSTS OF Assistant Executive Engineer (Electrical, Civil, Telecom, Mechanical & Electronics) across various Power Utilities.
POWERING ANDHRA - EMPOWERING FUTURE.
Andhra Pradesh Power Utilities have issued notification on **25.06.2026** to fill the posts of Assistant Executive Engineers across various Power Utilities on Direct recruitment through AP Vidyut Recruitment Portal <https://apvidyutrecruitment.apcfs.in> as follows:

www.aptransco.gov.in

	Electrical	Telecom	Civil	Total Posts
	167	10	23	200

www.apgenco.gov.in

	Electrical	Mechanical	Civil	Electronics	Total Posts
	52	21	20	7	100

www.apeasternpower.com

	Electrical	Telecom	Civil	Total Posts
	128	3	4	135

www.apcpdcl.in

	Electrical	Telecom	Civil	Total Posts
	56	1	3	60

www.apspdcl.in

	Electrical	Telecom	Civil	Total Posts
	124	4	6	134

The online application process commenced on 30.06.2026. The last date for submission of **online applications is 20.07.2026**. Detailed information is available on the respective utility websites and on AP Vidyut Recruitment portal: <https://apvidyutrecruitment.apcfs.in>.
Sd/- CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (HRD)
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/93/26-27

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR
No.: <http://mpt202627/4211> - 2026
अपवाकलीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 211/2026-27
Date: 06/07/2026

निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पावर सूची हेतु ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाइन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-
कार्य का विवरण
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:-
On Diggi-Sohela BDT Road for a period of 01 Year. **UBN: RRC2627SL0B00337** 624.50 Lakh
निविदा से सम्बंधित प्रश्न में निम्नलिखित सूचना, कोशर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहीत सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाइट: <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajjasthan.nic.in> तथा <http://pwwd.rajjasthan.gov.in/rsrdc> पर देखा जा सकता है।
दृष्टिकोण से संशोधन ई-निविदा से संबंधित विवरण वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाता आवश्यक है।
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कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियंता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाग, अजमेर
क्रमांक:- अमुअ/अन./तक./एफ.-2(30ए)/निविदा/डी-898
दिनांक:- 24.06.2026
निविदा सूचना संख्या 12 वर्ष 2026-2027
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल मोदीय की ओर से चोटिशियल अससमेंट पद्धति के अनुसार सड़क कार्य के लिए उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, राजस्थान में पंजीकृत अथवा राज्य सरकार के अन्य विभागों/केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/ड्राफ्ट एवं दूर संचार विभाग/रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत एए श्रेणी के संवेद्यकों से निर्धारित प्रश्न में ई-प्रोक्चरमेंट प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन निविदा प्राप्त की जावेगी। ई-निविदा से संबंधित विवरण वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।
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Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, C-Scheme, Jaipur-302005 (Raj.)
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Ref. No.: F-02 (445)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-07/2026-27/4535
Corrigendum - I in NIB-07/2026-27
In Reference to NIB No. F.02 (445)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-07/2026-27/4384 Dated :- 02.06.2026 UBN No. MSC2627GLRSC00025
Corrigendum-I is issued for date extension in bid. All details may be seen on <https://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> <https://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> & <https://www.rmsc.health.rajjasthan.gov.in>.
Raj.Samwad/C26/6290
Director (Proc.) RMSCL

KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
CIN: U85110KA1970SGC001919
BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Two Cover System) (Through KPP Portal only)
KPCL invites tenders through "e" Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> for the following works:

BELLARY THERMAL POWER STATION
1) Tender No. KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4333 Date: 02.07.2026 ESP, flue gas and air ducts, gages and dampers along with allied equipments overhauling works of Unit#1, 500MW. Amount put to tender: Rs.39.81 Lakhs. EMD: Rs.79.650/-.
2) Tender No. KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4287 Date: 02.07.2026 Overhauling works of Unit # 1, 500MW BTPS Boiler Air Pre Heater and rectification of economiser duct to APH outlet hangers. Amount put to tender: Rs.39.61 Lakhs. EMD: Rs.79.220/-.
3) Tender No. KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4332 Date: 02.07.2026 ID, PD, PA and Scanner air fans overhauling work of Unit #1, 500MW. Amount put to tender: Rs.13.49 Lakhs. EMD: Rs.34,000/-.
4) Tender No. KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4320 Date: 02.07.2026 Overhauling of High Pressure valves and Safety valves, Boiler drum and other expander/pressure tanks, assisting in floating of Safety valves and online safety valve floating and storage setting and cold setting/servicing of critical piping hangers/misc. hangers/buckstay beams & The work of cleaning buck stays, removal/replacement SS wire mesh of boiler for Unit#1 500MW of BTPS. Amount put to tender: Rs.15.73 Lakhs. EMD: Rs.39,500/-.
5) Tender No. KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4320 Date: 02.07.2026 Availing services of experts for supervision of emergency and overhauling works of Boiler and Aux. Unit - 1, 2 & 3 at BTPS. Amount put to tender: Rs.22.67 Lakhs. EMD: Rs.50,000/-.
Contract period (each work): 1 year extendable by six months. Last date for the BM-1 to 15: As per KPP Portal. Further details can be obtained from Executive Engineer (BM-1).
Procurement of- 6) KPCL/2026-27/IND2688 APH main drive gear box spares, 7) KPCL/2026-27/IND2565 Welding electrodes. 8) KPCL/2026-27/IND2583 Railway Track Materials. 9) KPCL/2026-27/IND2596 Ash Handling Spares. 10) KPCL/2026-27/IND2602 Castable refractory. 11) KPCL/2025-26/IND2393/CALL-2 HP Pump Spares for AHP. 12) KPCL/2025-26/IND2447 Bland Packings. 13) KPCL/2025-26/IND2443 BFP RC Valves Spares. 14) KPCL/2026-27/IND2590 Turbine O-Rings Spares. Last date for receipt of tenders: For Sl. No. 6: 15.07.2026, For Sl. No. 7: 20.07.2026. For Sl. No. 8 to 11 & 14: 21.07.2026. For Sl. No. 12 & 13: 17.07.2026. Further details can be obtained from Executive Engineer (Purchase), BTPS, KPCL, Kudathur-583152. Mobile: 094808 30377. E-mail: eeppurchasbtp@gmail.com.
RAICHUR THERMAL POWER STATION
15) Tender No. KPCL/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT4378 Date: 04.07.2026 Providing water proof treatment with Thermoplastic Polyolefin (TPO) membrane to 220kV, 400kV ODY Control room, HRD canteen and other connected works at RTPS. Class of contractor: Class-II and above contractors registered in KPWD. Amount put to tender: Rs.38.133 Lakhs (Excluding GST). Work completion period: 04 months. Further details can be obtained from the office of the Executive Engineer (PCM-2), KPCL, RTPS, Shaktinagar-584170. Dist. Raichur during office hours Mobile:94945 96582.

A CH-CHE

Israeli strike in south Lebanon kills four, including three women



Ebola outbreak death count in DR Congo crosses 500, says WHO



Thousands flee homes as wildfires continue across southern Europe



Macron in Syria on first post-Assad visit by a major Western leader



CM
YK

UNFAIR

Belgium coach mocks FIFA’s call to suspend Balogun red card



AFP

Belgium coach Rudi Garcia mocked FIFA’s decision to suspend USA striker Folarin Balogun’s red card. “I didn’t know that in the offices of FIFA the fifth of July was the first of April in Europe. The Belgian federation does not defend itself. It is defending football in general. It’s the first time in the World Cup that there is this kind of decision.”

POLITICAL INTERVENTION?

Trump reveals he asked FIFA chief Infantino to review Balogun’s foul



FILE PHOTO

US President Donald Trump said he asked FIFA chief Gianni Infantino to review a red-card foul against USA’s Folarin Balogun. “All I did was ask for a review, because I didn’t think it was a foul... I think the referee’s call was horrible. I didn’t tell them what to do. I can’t tell them what to do,” he said.

RESILIENT

We found a way despite everything going against us: England’s Kane



AP

I’ve just been singing... I can’t really talk. The occasion, the team, everything against us, and we found a way. The referee gave a lot against us. In the end, it didn’t matter, so I’m happy — England captain Harry Kane after the 3-2 victory over co-host Mexico at the Azteca Stadium on Sunday.

RALLYING TOGETHER

What we’ve done is spectacular: Bellingham after thrilling win



AFP

I can imagine everyone’s together. And that’s the thing I dream of being a part of this England squad, bringing my country together, giving them nights like this that they’ll enjoy hopefully for many years to come. What we’ve done is spectacular — Jude Bellingham, who scored a brace in Sunday’s 3-2 win over Mexico.



First strike: Haaland, right, outwits Gabriel in an aerial duel to hand Norway the lead. AFP

Norway in dreamland

Haaland’s brace secures the Scandinavians a maiden quarterfinal berth and knocks Brazil out; Guimaraes misses a penalty early in the first half

FIFA WORLD CUP

Avon Sengupta
NEW YORK

In New Jersey, where *The Sopranos* taught pop culture to prefer its stories tense, bruising and never entirely clean, Brazil’s round-of-16 match against Norway on Sunday felt suitably local. Carlo Ancelotti’s side had the pedigree, the glamour and the heavier billing, but it was left beaten 2-1 by Erling Haaland’s second-half double that sent the Scandinavians into the World Cup quarterfinals for the first time.

There were three pockets of red around the right-end goal in an otherwise rolling wave of scarf-waving canary yellow, but the Norwegians, belting out ‘Viking Row’, were still loud enough to make themselves heard.

Brazil was handed a route into the contest when Matheus Cunha was brought down by Kristoffer Ajer in the box, with VAR reversing the referee’s original decision. Bruno

Guimaraes stepped up, but after a stuttering run, drove his effort too close to Orjan Nyland, who read it right and pushed it away with a firm hand.

Much to the surprise of those inside the stadium, Norway enjoyed the healthier share of possession — close to 70% in the opening quarter — as Brazil clearly missed the injured Lucas Paqueta’s ability to stich the game together.

Haaland finally found a sight of goal in the 37th minute when Antonio Nusa whipped a ball in from the left, but the striker’s side-footed hook lacked both power and direction to trouble Alisson Becker. Soon after, Vinicius Junior pounced on a rare Norwegian lapse and fired in a snapshot from the left, but Nyland threw his frame across the angle like a nightclub doorman shutting out trouble.

In the dying moments of the half, two Brazilian defenders lost a jostling match with Haaland and the loose ball dropped invitingly for Martin Odegaard. His shot, however, was smothered by the on-

rushing Alisson. On the hour mark, a sharp release from Vinicius down the left sent the newly introduced Endrick clear on goal. The teenager, though, flicked his finish wide with just Nyland to beat.

Neymar’s first appearance of the World Cup in the 68th minute drew a roar from the stands. Instead, the breakthrough came for Norway. In the 79th minute, Andreas Schjelderup bent in a cross from the left and Haaland stole half a yard on Gabriel to head past Alisson for the opener.

Any hope of a Brazilian turnaround was extinguished soon enough. Haaland gathered the ball outside the box and drove a left-footed shot through Danilo’s legs and beyond Alisson into the far corner.

Deep in stoppage time, Brazil was awarded another penalty after Leo Ostigard elbowed Casemiro in the box. Neymar stepped up to score, ending a 1,030-day wait for a national-team goal, but the strike came too late to alter the outcome.

Neymar confirms his Brazil career is over

Agence France-Presse
EAST RUTHERFORD

Brazil superstar Neymar indicated on Sunday that his international career was over after the five-time World Cup winning team went out of the tournament in the last 16 at the hands of Norway.

Neymar came on as a late substitute at the MetLife Stadium and scored a penalty deep in injury time, but that was a mere consolation after Brazil lost 1-2.

The 34-year-old is Brazil’s all-time top scorer, and, ironically, he got his first goal for his country in the same stadium, in a 2-0 win against the United States back in 2010.

“I tried and I tried. Now it’s over. It began here, and it ends here,” Neymar said in a brief exchange with a journalist from Brazil’s *Globo Esporte* after the game.

He collapsed in tears when the final whistle went, and had to be consoled by teammates.

Worn down by injuries in recent years, the former Barcelona and Paris Saint-Germain player, now back at first club Santos, was a surprise inclusion in Carlo Ancelotti’s Brazil squad for the World Cup.



Neymar. REUTERS



Jude’s day out: An unmarked Bellingham punishes Mexico with a pin-point header. AFP

‘Ten’acious England surfs over the Mexican wave

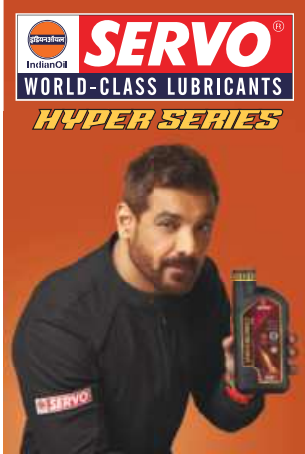
Reuters
MEXICO CITY

Ten-man England weathered a Mexico storm at the Azteca Stadium on Sunday to reach the World Cup quarterfinals for the third straight time. The Thomas Tuchel-coached side notched up a rip-roaring 3-2 victory over the co-host, thanks to a Jude Bellingham brace and Harry Kane penalty.

England made it hard for itself and handed Mexico its first World Cup defeat at the iconic venue to set up a last-eight clash with Norway. Mexico had lost only two competitive games at Azteca in 89 matches since 1966, but England deserved to make it three.

After the game was delayed by an hour due to thunderstorms, Mexico attacked from the start and was backed by its fanatical support, who raised the decibel level compared to the previous matches. England, however, held firm.

Bellingham put England ahead with a diving header from Bukayo Saka’s fine cross past the half-hour mark. The midfielder made



it 2-0 within two minutes as another break down the right saw captain Harry Kane set up Bellingham.

The Mexican crowd came up with chants of “Yes we can”, and their players responded when livewire winger Julian Quinones volleyed home inside the box after a scramble following a free-kick.

The co-host got further encouragement after the break when England defender Jarell Quansah was sent off for a rash challenge. The visitor kept its cool, though, and after Anthony Gordon was fouled by the ‘keeper on the hour, Kane calmly scored from the

THE RESULTS
▼
Round of 16: Brazil 1 (Neymar 90+10-pen) lost to Norway 2 (Haaland 79, 90). Mexico 2 (Quinones 42, Jimenez 69-pen) lost to England 3 (Bellingham 36, 38, Kane 60-pen).

Wednesday’s match
ROUND OF 16
Switzerland vs. Colombia, 1.30 a.m.
The day and time pertain to India

spot. Just as England looked to enjoy some breathing space, Kane gave away a penalty after a VAR review and Raul Jimenez stepped up to make it 3-2. With just over 20 minutes to go, England had its backs to the wall.

Despite giving up most of the possession, it hung on for a famous victory in the last match of this World Cup in Mexico.

It was England’s first visit to the famous stadium since it lost to Argentina in the 1986 quarterfinals when Diego Maradona’s infamous ‘Hand of God’ goal and mazy dribble through a hapless defence sank Bobby Robson’s side.

The time has come for Messi vs. Salah

Avon Sengupta

Both Argentina and Egypt needed 120 draining minutes to survive their opening knockout ties and had barely four days to recover before meeting for a place in the World Cup quarterfinals. For Argentina, that short turnaround has come with a little more anxiety after Lionel Scaloni’s side came within minutes of a seismic upset before edging Cabo Verde 3-2 after extra-time. Egypt, meanwhile, is here after beating Australia 4-2 (1-1 after extra-time) on penalties.

Scaloni did not hide his frustration with the scheduling after the win in Miami. “Now to rest. I don’t know how the World Cup is made but we had six days, and now we have three and a half. When you need the rest the most, you have the least.” The Latin American team’s discomfort with physicality will encourage Hossam Hassan’s Egypt. “We aren’t focusing on Messi,” assistant coach Ibrahim Hassan said. “They might have Messi, but we have Mohamed Salah, and we have 26 Messis of our own.”

Argentina will try to reassert midfield control and might bring in Leandro Paredes. Egypt will sit in a compact block and wait for moments to release Mohamed Salah and Omar Marmoush into the spaces. Ahmed El Fotouh, Karim Hafez and Mohamed Abdelmonem are racing against time to recover from knocks, while Argentina might bring back Nicolas Tagliafico. Scaloni is expected to keep faith with the same core, but after 120 exhausting minutes, Atlanta may reveal whether Friday was a stumble or the first real crack in the champions’ defence.

Match starts at 9.30 p.m. IST today.

Paolini ends Eala’s fairytale run, sets up last-eight clash with Kostyuk



Marching on: Paolini overcame a mid-match wobble to put paid to Eala’s hopes. AFP

WIMBLEDON

N. Sudarshan
LONDON

Few bonds in the world are formed as quickly as the one between an eager audience and an exciting sportsperson.

It is like love at first sight, with the infatuation deep from the very first encounter.

Jasmine Paolini experienced this first hand when she made a mesmerising run to the Wimbledon final in 2024, with the Italian’s bubbly demeanour and clear-cut strokes instantly endearing her to the populace in south west London.

On Monday, in her first match on Centre Court since that bitter-sweet afternoon, Paolini re-esta-

blished the connection and rode on the rekindled affection to beat Alexandra Eala 6-4, 4-6, 6-3. In the quarterfinals, she will meet Ukraine’s Marta Kostyuk.

Eala, 21, was coming into the match on the back of a stunning triumph over defending champion Iga Swiatek. The Filipino’s fleet-footed tennis and her inspiring back story had made her a fan favourite over the past week.

But the crowd at the All England Club did not quite supplant Paolini with Eala but made space for both, cheering dispassionately for over two hours and 20 minutes.

This spirit was exhibited even by Roger Federer, who had joined fellow greats such as Billie Jean King in the royal box, and it was duly acknowledged by a chuffed Paolini in her

THE RESULTS

▼
Fourth round: Men: 9-Cobolli (Ita) bt 5-de Minaur (Aus) 7-5, 7-6 (4), 6-3; 1-Sinner (Ita) bt Mochizuki (Jpn) 6-3, 7-6(0), 6-3; Struff (Ger) bt Hurkacz (Pol) 3-6, 6-7(5), 7-6(2), 7-5, 4-2, ret.; 3-Auger-Aliassime (Can) bt 22-Fokina (Esp) 6-7(4), 7-6(6), 6-3, 6-7(2), 6-1.
Women: 9-Noskova (Cze) bt 26-Keys (USA) 6-4, 7-6(2); 13-Paolini (Ita) bt 29-Eala (Phi) 6-4, 4-6, 6-3; 12-Kostyuk (Ukr) bt Krueger (USA) 6-4, 6-4.
25-Mertens (Bel) bt 21-Bouzokva (Cze) 6-4, 6-4; 7-Gauff (USA) bt 11-Bencic (Sui) 4-6, 6-3, 6-4.
Fallen seeds: Men: 5-de Minaur, 22-Fokina. **Women:** 11-Bencic, 26-Keys, 29-Eala.

post-match speech.

Much of the contest was up and down. Paolini raced to a 4-1 lead, breaking to 3-1 with a fine down-the-line backhand and then holding with a crisp volley.

But the World No. 17 wobbled in her two subsequent service games, and managed to erase two break-points only because of her spin-heavy second serve which Eala was unable to handle.

A break to 4-5 did eventually arrive for Eala following two forehand errors by Paolini, but she duly handed the initiative back and lost the set 4-6.

The second stanza followed a similar pattern, but with roles reversed. Eala displayed nerves of steel to claw her way back from 0-40 down to hold to 5-3, and she restored parity at one set apiece not long after.

In the decider, there were errors galore and they were mostly from Eala’s racquet. The most consequential of the lot arrived in the eighth game

when the World No. 32 dumped a double fault to give Paolini a break-point, and followed it up with a backhand that sailed long.

Paolini, who also reached the Roland-Garros final in 2024, did not miss the invitation to put the tie to rest. The 30-year-old did fall 0-30 behind, but a thunderous ace down the ‘T’ brought the anxiety down and helped her past the finish line.

“Stepping on these courts is something special,” Paolini said later. “It was a great atmosphere and I feel so lucky.”

“I have not played many matches [of late], and after the first set of the first round [which I lost 6-0], I was like okay: can only go better. Point by point, and game by game, I am working my way back. I am getting better,” she added.

INBRIEF



Shree Charani lone Indian in ICC Team of the Tournament

Spinner Shree Charani was the only Indian named in the Women's T20 World Cup 2026 Team of the Tournament announced by the ICC on Monday. The left-arm spinner earned her place after finishing as the leading wicket-taker with 14 scalps in just five matches – the second-highest tally ever recorded in a single edition of the women's T20 World Cup.

The team: Sophie Molineux (Australia, captain), Danni Wyatt-Hodge (England), Beth Mooney (Australia), Nat Sciver-Brunt (England), Ellyse Perry (Australia), Orla Prendergast (Ireland), Nilakshika Silva (Sri Lanka), Marizanne Kapp (South Africa), Ashleigh Gardner (Australia), Fatima Sana (Pakistan), and Shree Charani (India).

Hope and Greaves combine well in Windies' spirited reply

West Indies was 318 for four in reply to Sri Lanka's first innings total of 549 for nine declared at stumps on the third day of the second and final Test in Antigua on Sunday.

The scores: Sri Lanka 549/9 decl. in 139.3 overs vs. West Indies 318/4 in 111 overs (John Campbell 72, Shai Hope 86 batting, Justin Greaves 85 batting).

Firouzja wins title; Pragg finishes tied third

Indian GM R. Pragganandhaa finished tied third in the Croatian leg of Grand Chess Tour in Zagreb on Monday. France's Alireza Firouzja bagged the top honours with 23.5 points. Firouzja won \$47,000 for his efforts, Abdusattorov got \$42,000 while Pragganandhaa and Vachier-Lagrave shared \$25,000 each.

Final standings: 1. Alireza Firouzja (Fra) 23.5 points; 2. Nodirbek Abdusattorov (Uzb) 23.5; 3. Maxime Vachier-Lagrave (Fra) and R. Pragganandhaa 21.5; 5. Vincent Keymer (Ger) 20; 6. D. Gukesh 18.5; 7. Anish Giri (Ned) 17; 8. Deac Bogdan-Daniel (Rou) 15; and Jorden van Foreest (Ned) 12.5; 10. Ivan Saric (Cro) 7.

Pogacar wins Tour de France third stage, takes yellow

Reigning champion Tadej Pogacar won the third stage of the Tour de France, to snatch the leader's yellow jersey from Jonas Vingegaard, who finished second ahead of Richard Carapaz on Monday. The World champion and Vingegaard are dead level on time but Pogacar took over the race lead by virtue of his better finishing positions in the opening three stages.

World Archery upgrades Surekha's bronze to silver

World Archery on Monday upgraded Jyothi Surekha's bronze medal won at the 2025 Hyundai Archery World Cup Final in Nanjing, to silver after Mexico's Marina Bernal was disqualified for violating anti-doping regulations. Bernal's sample led to her disqualification under World Archery Federation Rule 3, prompting an official revision of the competition results. The 23-year-old tested positive for an anabolic steroid (nandrolone) in an out-of-competition test in September and is banned until after the 2028 Olympics.

The revised standings: Gold: Andrea Becerra (Mexico); **Silver:** Jyothi Surekha (India); **Bronze:** Ella Gibson (Great Britain).

ENGAGEMENTS

Aquatics: 79th senior National championship (diving and water polo); inauguration, chief guests R.N. Jayprakash, SFI President, Dr. Pankaj Mittal, Secretary-General, Association of Indian Universities, SRM IST (Kattankulathur), 4 p.m.

Cricket: TNCA league, I div., fifth round, Swaraj vs. Vijay (Wahe Guru-A); Grand Slam vs. Globe Trotters (Talore); Jolly Rovers vs. Nelson (Murugappa); MRC-A vs. Pristine (Gojan-A); Singam Puli vs. Sea Hawks (Gojan-B); SKM vs. Young Stars (Madras Cricket Ground, Vanagaram), day three, 9.15 a.m. Tagore Sports-TNCA C. Ramaswamy Trophy u-16 city schools tournament, St. Bede's-A (Mylapore) vs. Chettinad Vidyashram (R.A. Puram), Union; Green Field IS vs. Olive Tree Global, MIT; Velammal Vidyalaya-A (Alappakkam) vs. Ramachandra PS (Kottivakkam), Sumangali; PSBB-B (K.K. Nagar) vs. Everwin Vidyashram-A (Kolathur), Gandhi Nagar; The Schram Academy CBSE & Cambridge IS vs. Velammal Vidyalaya-B (Alappakkam), GE-A; Don Bosco-A (Egmore) vs. St. Michael's Academy (Adyar), GE-B; Jawahar Vidyalaya-B (Ashok Nagar) vs. Sunshine Chennai (Madipakkam), SMK Fomra-A; The Hindu (Adyar) vs. PSBB (Siruseri), SMK Fomra-B, 8 a.m. Sri Chaitanya Techno (Perungudi) vs. Chennai Boys (Nungambakkam), Union; Maharishi Vidya Mandir (Choolai) vs. APL Global, MIT; Sri Krish IS vs. SBOA School & Jr. College (Anna Nagar), Sumangali; Santhome-A (Santhome) vs. Jai Gopal Garodia Hindu Vidyalaya, Gandhi Nagar; St. Bede's-B vs. CSI Ewart MHSS (Anna Nagar), GE-A; Nellai Nadar (Kottivakkam) vs. KRM PS (Perambur), GE-B; Sishya OMR (Thoraiyakkam) vs. Santhome-B, SMK Fomra-A; St. Patrick's (Adyar) vs. Heartfulness IS-A (Kolappakkam), SMK Fomra-B, 1 p.m.

Team Australia in a league of its own

Molineux & Co. steamroll to victory in a tournament seen as the most open; England comes up short in the final; India flatters to deceive

T20 WORLD CUP

P.K. Ajith Kumar
LONDON

England is gorgeously, soothingly green. Trees, parks, meadows, vast farmlands that never seem to end. You won't want to take your eyes off the side-view, be it you are travelling on the road or on the rail. Hardly surprising then that this country has produced the likes of Wordsworth, Keats and Coleridge.

There has, however, been a terrible heatwave that could have given a run to Chennai for its money. And it could be pretty warm over the next one week, too. But it still may not be hotter than the form Australia showed right through the Women's T20 World Cup, which came to a predictable end in front of a full house at Lord's on Sunday.

They had called it the most open World Cup yet. England, New Zealand, South Africa and India began as genuine contenders, yes. But once the tourna-



Rampant: The Australian juggernaut rolled over its opponents in all the matches. REUTERS

ment started, and once those magnificent Australian women, sporting green instead of the usual yellow, stepped on to the field and steamrolled the opposition, it became more and more obvious that they were playing their cricket on a different level than the rest.

England seemed the

team best equipped to challenge them. The host had a sharp attack, predominantly spin but there was also the pace of Lauren Bell, the top-order led by Danni Wyatt-Hodge was firing, and even a less than fully-fit captain Nat Sciver-Brunt was always ready to come up with a superwoman effort.

But, England was only second best. The Australians showed that in no uncertain terms in the final. When they reduced England to 150 for four, it was virtually the game over: even a target of over 200 wouldn't have been beyond the reach of a powerful batting line-up that was almost as endless as

the farmlands in England.

It was Beth Mooney, after a spectacular show behind the stumps, that led the chase. Ellyse Perry, Ashleigh Gardner and Mooney are players who were also parts of an even greater Australian side that had women like Meg Lanning and Alyssa Healy. Make no mistake, Sophie

Molineux's side too is a great one, and youngsters like Phoebe Litchfield and Georgia Voll have made the transition look as if there was no transition at all, just a change of personnel.

That meant the Aussies were never stretched in the seven games they played at the World Cup. India in the last group match gave them at least 171 to chase, which was accomplished with just one over to spare. That is what the scoreboard would tell you; Australia, thanks to a remarkable Perry-Gardner partnership, had already taken control of the match long before.

It was, of course, a huge disappointment for Harmanpreet Kaur's women after their historic triumph in the ODI World Cup at home, but this team has some glaring weaknesses and depends too much on a few players. Scotland, Ireland and the Netherlands, justified the World Cup's expansion.

And there were record-breaking attendances, in spite of England's huge interest at the football World Cup across the pond.

Mooney the smartest I have played with, says Molineux

P.K. Ajith Kumar
LONDON

In a team of so many superstars, Beth Mooney may not have got her due often enough. But, she keeps delivering. The bigger the occasion, the better.

She was named the Player-of-the-Match in Sunday's final of the Women's T20 World Cup at Lord's. She was also named the Player-of-the-Tournament.

And she has done it before. She was the best player of the final at the 2023 T20 World Cup in South Africa. She was the best player of the T20 World Cup that Australia won at home.

During those World Cups, Mooney could focus solely on her batting, as her opening partner Alyssa Healy had kept wicket. After the captain's retirement, Mooney has been donning the keeping gloves, and has been more than effective.

That she is an astute reader of the game helps. "She is probably the smar-



Safe and sharp: Mooney has donned the big gloves with aplomb after Healy's retirement. AFP

test cricketer I have ever played with," Australian skipper Sophie Molineux said. "The way she can sum up situations and be able to grind out innings at the same time... she has got all the shots and is able to play freely. She has got nerves of steel."

The captain said Mooney was the leader in the group. "Girls listen when she speaks," said Molineux. "She is the backbone to our batting group. Her

wicketkeeping was next level in the final."

Mooney, however, reacted to those words from her captain thus: "It is a great compliment from Soph, but I think I'm a little bit of a fraud," she said.

"I just enjoy the contest, enjoy getting better and evolving my game, and enjoy contributing to team success whichever side it is."

Any team is lucky to have Mooney.

Siddharth, Mathivanan bag five each, but Sea Hawks takes lead

TNCA FIRST DIVISION

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Left-arm spinners M. Siddharth (five for 52) and M. Mathivanan (five for 64) helped Singam Puli bowl out Sea Hawks for 205 on the second day of the TNCA first division league at Gojan-B on Monday.

Sea Hawks, however, secured a 20-run first-innings lead. In its second essay, Singam Puli reached 98 for four at stumps, holding an overall lead of 78.

The scores:
At Wahe-Guru-A: Swaraj 389 in 123.2 overs (R. Javed Mohammed 128, Mohit Panghal 47 n.o., Nidhish S. Rajagopal 3/51, R. Sai Kishore 3/84) vs. Vijay 142/2 in 52.4 overs (Tushar Raheja 90, K.T.A. Madhava Prasad 33).

At Madras Cricket Grounds: Young Stars 426/9 decl. in 151 overs (Aditya Varadharajan 139, A. Badrinath 37, Subhan Krishnan Sridhar 32, S. Mohan Prasath 31 n.o., Rahil Shah 4/115, M. Ganesh Moorthi 4/104) vs. SKM CC 66/3 in 29 overs.

At Tagore College: Grand Slam



Siddharth (Singam Puli, 5/52); Mathivanan (Singam Puli, 5/64); Abhinav (Grand Slam, 113 n.o.); Mohana Prasath (Grand Slam, 102 n.o.).



Javed (Swaraj, 128); Radhakrishnan (Nelson, 102).



Vijay Shankar (MRC-A, 102). Ferrario 3/23) vs. Sea Hawks 205 in 81 overs (R.S. Mokit Hariharan 32, P. Shijit Chandran 43, P. Saravanan 30, M. Siddharth 5/52, M. Mathivanan 5/64).

LIVE TELECAST

Wimbledon: Star Sports 1, 2, SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 3.30 p.m.
West Indies vs Sri Lanka: Second Test, Day 5, FanCode, 7.30 p.m.
FIFA World Cup: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 9.30 p.m. & 1.30 a.m. (Wednesday)
England vs India: Third T20I, Sony Sports Ten 1 & JioHotstar, 10 p.m.

CITY SCHOOLS UNDER-16

Sarvesh's five-wicket haul does it for Marg Vidhyalaya

Sarvesh scalped five for 18, which included a hat-trick, to bowl Marg Vidhyalaya (Madipakkam) to a 108-run win over Sir Sivaswami Kalalaya in a TNCA city schools under-16 match on Monday.

The scores:
St. Mary's MHSS (Perambur) 80 in 25.4 overs (R. Aadarsh 3/15) lost to Chettinad Vidyashram 81/5 in 10.4 overs (Laakash 36, D. Lavanik 3/7).
Sri Sankara 155 in 28.4 overs (R. Keshav 43, Mahammad Raasul Adil 3/6) lost to APL Global 157/4 in 29.5 overs (N. Neil Nithwin 43, R. Shravan 57).
Velammal Vidyalaya-A 205/5 in 30 overs (S.T. Amizhthan 30, G.S. Dharmavan 74) bt Dr. Vimala Convent 47 in 17.1 overs (A.G. Dhanish Ibrahim 3/16, B. Ashwin 3/7).
MCC 84 in 27.2 overs (Muhammed Ibrahim 30, V. Prapanchan 3/11) lost to Santhome HSS 87/0 in nine overs (G. Yashwanth 57).
KRM PS 215/0 in 30 overs (V. Kaushik 103 n.o., S. Rethish 102 n.o.) bt Sir Mutha School-B 74 in 19.2 overs (Sai Santhosh 3/20, K. Harshan 4/3).



Sarvesh (Marg Vidhyalaya 5/18, including a hat-trick; A. Sanjith (Don Bosco-B, 125 n.o.); Dishi (PS Senior, 5/6); Rethish (KRM, 102 n.o.)

Don Bosco-B (Egmore) 326/3 in 30 overs (Mayank Dhruva 69, A. Sanjith 125 n.o., Darla Yuvan 66 n.o.) bt Sri Chaitanya Techno 69 in 15.3 overs (Jai Vishnu 3/16).
DAV Boys 126/8 in 27 overs (P.M. Kaushik (KRM Sikar Saurabh PS, 103 n.o.).
31, G. Dakshana 3/27) bt Govt. HSS-B 76 in 20.2 overs (R. Ashwin 4/10).
St. Patrick's 155/8 in 28 overs (S. Sanjay 52, V. Keerthivasan 3/28, G. Anirudh 3/27) bt A.M. Jain School 150/5 in 26 overs (K. Advaita Narayanan 67, B. Keshav 41).
Maharishi Vidya Mandir 136/8 in 30 overs (Sujith Vijay 34, J. Anto Jenshik 35, S. Srikrishna 3/20) lost to Jawahar Vidyalaya-B 137/8 in 29.3 overs (Harish Karthick 51).
K.S.N. Senior 173/9 in 30 overs

(Sanjay Shanmugam 56, S Kaushik Sai 30, S. Jegath Sai 3/23) bt DAV PS 144 in 27.3 overs (P. Yuvan Balaji 38, A. Arjun 3/18, Krishiv Srinivasa Koduri 4/17).
Jeppia CBSE School (Semmancheri) 157 in 24.5 overs (Diyansh Raj 47, K. Jagadish 4/11) bt PS Senior 77 in 28.4 overs (H. Dishi 5/6).
Avichi HSS 140/7 in 30 overs (N. Shamindhar 66, Kishvanth 3/21) lost to Heartfulness International School NIOS-B 144/0 in 16.3 overs (Yuvanesh 68 n.o., R. Harshad 67 n.o.).
Marg Vidhyalaya 190/6 in 30 overs (R.V. Kevin 54, Aarav 33 n.o.) bt Sir Sivaswami Kalalaya (Mylapore) 82 in 21.3 overs (Sarvesh 5/18).
PSBB Nungambakkam 281/6 in 30 overs (Rishab Malhotra 45, Siddhaan Shanker Ramen 83, Vansh Kumar Jain 62, B. Pranav 37 n.o.) bt The Shri Ram Universal School 71 in 24 overs (Garvit Jain 32).

AROUND THE CITY

Maiden title for Umesh, Ananya claims double
K. Umesh of RTTHPC secured his first men's title, beating clubmate S. Tharun 11-8, 14-12, 8-11, 11-13, 11-9, 7-11, 11-5 in the final of the 3rd SBM-TNTTA State Ranking tournament at the ICF indoor stadium. M. Ananya put up an impressive show, claiming the u-19 and u-17 girls' titles. Arjuna awardee and former National champion, A. Amalraj, distributed the prizes.

The results (finals): Women: Selena Deepthi (RTTHPC) bt N. Sharvani (Mylapore Club) 11-5, 5-11, 11-3, 11-2, 12-10.
Boys: u-9: S. Adhvik (MAK Chandra TTA) bt Divit Jain (SK Academy) 13-11, 11-8, 11-8; **u-11:** T.K. Akshath (Dronacharya TTA) bt M. Muhammad Rehan (ITTC) 11-5, 11-1, 11-7; **u-13:** R. Sujeth (Bestshot TTA) bt H. Tanish (SK Academy) 11-3, 12-10, 11-9; **u-15:** J.N. Sanjay Arwindh (SK Academy) bt Krish Vinodh (Vinnin) 11-8, 11-6, 11-5; **u-17:** J.N. Sanjay Arwindh bt M. Mohammed (SK Academy) 12-14, 11-3, 11-6, 11-7; **u-19:** S. Sriram (Chennai Achievers) bt S. Mehan



Champions all: The winners of the third SBM-TNTTA State-ranking table tennis tournament. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

(Chennai Achievers) 12-10, 6-11, 11-2, 11-6, 11-8.
Girls: u-9: Sharadha Ramakrishnan (MST) bt N. Yanthi (Coimbatore) 11-9, 9-11, 11-9, 11-5; **u-11:** D. Lathikasree (BTTA) bt H. Dhiya (Bestshot TTA) 15-13, 9-11, 11-7, 6-11, 11-7; **u-13:** V.G. Harshika (Madurai) bt D. Pratika (SSA-ERD) 11-5, 11-9, 10-12, 11-5; **u-15:** B. Varnica (SSA-ERD) bt H. Thanishkaa (Bestshot TTA) 9-11, 11-5, 11-5, 11-3; **u-17:** M. Ananya (Chennai Achievers) bt M.R. Moksha (SK Academy) 11-6, 8-11, 11-9, 11-6; **u-19:** M. Ananya bt B.R. Nandhini (MVM) 11-8, 11-7, 11-5, 11-11.
Veteran: G. Vinodh (SRSA) bt L. Vigneshwaran (SSHI) 11-9, 10-12, 10-12, 11-9, 11-7; **Corporate:** G.

Prasanna Kumaar (SK Academy) bt L. Vigneshwaran 11-9, 11-6, 11-13, 11-4.
Special awards: Best academy: SK Academy; **Best district player (Vasudevan Memorial Trophy):** Yashika Sasha (Nilgiris).

Inter-school cricket tournament

Friends CA will conduct a u-13 boys' inter-school cricket tournament from July 14 at the N.M. Greens ground. The last date of entry is July 12.

For further details, contact Abdul @ 99624 04093.

India's worrisome threesome

At a time when superstars are showcasing their greatness with age-defying performances on the big stage, the Men in Blue continue to ponder over the elephant in the room: a seam-bowling all-rounder in white-ball formats

R. Kaushik

When FIFA, football's world governing body, decreed some nine-and-a-half years back that the sport's flagship event, the World Cup, would be expanded to 48 teams from the existing 32 from the 2026 edition, it was received with mixed feelings. Nations that had narrowly missed out on qualification were energised by the prospect of 16 additional berths boosting their prospects to a reasonable degree. Others weren't merely sceptical or apprehensive, they vehemently dismissed it as a populous, self-serving, self-defeating decision.

The backers believed the expansion of the World Cup to 48 countries was in keeping with football's standing as easily the most popular sporting endeavour in the universe. That it would encourage the piecing together of infrastructure and systems in the 'lesser' nations because now, there was plenty of light at the end of the foreboding tunnel. Sides that would once have reconciled to merely watching the action on television started to believe they had a chance, however distant or optimistic.

The naysayers insisted that going from 32 to 48 would dilute the standards of the tournament. They argued that the World Cup was the ultimate platform to showcase skills and character, that only the cream deserved that privilege. They forecast a plethora of lop-sided encounters, convinced that the established order would run roughshod over the newbies.

And so, when Cape Verde and Curacao fought their way into the World Cup, coming through the qualification process, they predicted routs of epic proportions. And yet, here we are today, with Curacao having hardly embarrassed themselves despite being routed 7-1 on their World Cup debut by Germany after earning an honourable 0-0 stalemate with Ecuador. And with Cape Verde giving Argentina, mighty Argentina, Messi-fuelled Argentina, the defending champions, a gargantuan scare in the round of 32.

As for the established order, four-time former champions Germany failed to advance beyond the last-32, dumped on penalties by Paraguay. The same day, a similar fate befell Netherlands, who also lost in a shoot-out to Morocco, the 2022 semifinalists.

The aftermath has been swift with Julian Nagelsmann stepping down as coach and Jurgen Klopp in talks with the German federation to take control and arrest an alarming slide. Likewise, Ronald Koeman called time on his tenure as the Dutch coach.

What the tangible impacts of their commendable World Cup debuts will have on Cape Verde and Curacao remains to be seen. Having come into the tournament as novelties rather than serious contenders, they showed that they weren't content to merely make up the numbers. They haven't been the only success stories of the tournament so far. Evidently, Lionel Messi, Kylian Mbappe, Erling Haaland and Harry Kane are jostling for prominence and pre-eminence as the race for top honours hots up a fortnight ahead of the July 19 final. But it is in the spunk and spirit shown by the two projected no-shows that the status of football as a mass sport has been enhanced.

Irresistible

There is something irresistible about rooting for the underdog, like Wimbledon did on Saturday when fast rising Filipino Alexandra Eala put out defending women's singles champion Iga Swiatek on Centre Court in the third round. The straight-set victory made Eala the first tennis player from her country, male or female, to advance to the fourth round of a Grand Slam.

To watch the overwhelming favourite systematically dismantle someone ranked far lower isn't necessarily enjoyable. No disrespect to the champions, because they need to be ruthlessly professional, not kind and empathetic, if they are to remain at the top. But to see a less fancied individual push, stretch and eventually conquer Goliath stirs something in the most dispassionate of us.

Ireland's 2-0 decimation of India in the recent T20I series falls in that category. Indian fans might not have been thrilled with the outcome, the Indian team even less so, but even the average Indian supporter hasn't exactly grudged the Irish their moment under the sun.

It was hardly the result Shreyas Iyer



would have envisaged or welcomed in his first outing as the T20I captain, but India can have few complaints even though they had just one meaningful practice session in Belfast before the first game. They are the World Cup holders and the No. 1-ranked team across the globe, but showed little alacrity in adapting to the unfamiliar (to them) conditions exploited superbly by the home team.

India's poor start to their tour of the United Kingdom has spilled over to England, who bossed the second T20I on Saturday (the first on Wednesday was abandoned due to rain after one innings) on the back of a Jacob Bethell special and a horror 17th over from leggie Ravi Bishnoi that was decisive in charting the destination of the contest. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's much expected debut wasn't spectacular - 14 from 10 - but the sixes he struck off Rajasthan Royals teammate Jofra Archer and Josh Tongue hold the promise to more, and sustained, fireworks in the remaining three games.

Sooryavanshi doesn't figure in the 50-over squad which will lock horns with Harry Brook's men in a three-match showdown next week; his time will come, eventually, though for now, the 15-year-old has to be content with being a one-format international (when was the last time we said this?).

In focus

The focus when the first of three ODIs plays out in Birmingham next Tuesday will be trained unerringly on two of India's most recent all-format captains, who will continue to attract unalloyed attention for the remainder of their international careers.

Cristiano Ronaldo, 41, is still producing (admittedly sporadic) moments of magic at the World Cup while Messi, three years younger, is scoring goals for fun and seeking to pull off what that other little genius from Argentina, Diego Maradona, could not accomplish - leading his team to a successful title defence. A staggering eight players aged 40 and more have figured in this World Cup - more than all previous 22 editions combined - while at 44, 23-time Grand Slam champion Serena Williams has embarked on a tentative comeback to the WTA Tour.

Indian cricket, however, frowns upon the 35-plus bracket - an improvement from 30-plus in the not-too-distant past, for whatever it is worth - which is why Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli have been under the arc lights for more than just that exceptional skills in the last 14 months, since they chose to become one-format internationals only.

To a certain degree, it is worth pondering over the physical conditioning of Rohit, 39, and the 37-year-old Kohli by the time the next 50-over World Cup comes around, in 15-and-a-half months' time. But maybe we should obsess a little

Nitish is only 23 and 10 Tests young, but he already has a Boxing Day ton to his name. He is being touted as the insurance, at the very least, against Hardik's trysts with fitness. But he hasn't inspired confidence with a plethora of injuries that have restricted his white-ball appearances to six ODIs and four T20Is since his limited-overs international debut in October 2024

less over these two stalwarts and reflect instead on a trio which brings a special skillset so far as India are concerned, who are a lot younger and who spend a lot of time on the sidelines, recovering from injuries, without attracting the same scrutiny as the two celebrated former skippers.

India have embarked on a fruitless, futile, impossible quest for a like-for-like replacement since the great Kapil Dev bid adieu in 1994 . The last three decades and more have thrown up quite a few pace-bowling quasi-all-rounders, but how can anyone replace Kapil? How can anyone ever? Naturally athletic, gifted with a silken smooth run-up and an out-swing to die for, and the most destructive of batters when the mood seized him, the legend from Haryana was three cricketers rolled in one.

India tried to make a Kapil out of numerous persevering but just not-in-the-same-league all-rounders, including current chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar, though the emergence of Hardik Pandya seemed finally to answer several, if not all, of their prayers.

Hardik decided very early in his international journey that his body couldn't handle the rigours of the five-day game, even though in 11 Tests, he both scored a blazing century and snared a commendable five-for. He hasn't, however, played a Test for close to eight years, dedicating himself to the two white-ball formats where his expertise with bat and ball lend great balance and flexibility.

Influential

He was an influential member of T20 World Cup triumphs in 2024 and 2026, and the 50-over Champions Trophy title charge, but the 32-year-old's is a fragile body which is increasingly relegating him more to the infirmary than allowing him to stride the world stage like a colossus.

Then, there is Nitish Kumar, only 23 and 10 Tests young, but with already a Boxing Day ton to his name. He is being touted as the insurance, at the very least, against Hardik's trysts with fitness, though he himself hasn't inspired confidence with a plethora of injuries that have restricted his white-ball appearances to six ODIs and four T20Is since his limited-overs international debut in



The storyline: Nitish, Hardik and Harshit have not helped India's cause with their injuries. The three are seen as integral members of the squad keeping in mind the 50-over World Cup in Africa next year. R. RAGU & B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM



Harshit is coming off an extended lay-off following a severe right knee injury while Nitish is nursing an aggravated left quadriceps injury, the latest in a long and unfortunate list

THE GIST

Nitish has had a stop-start run since his international debut while Harshit has a long way to go before being considered an all-rounder

Hardik's shift to Bengaluru is both a tribute to his commitment to the cause and an acknowledgement that his body needs constant monitoring and conditioning

The decision-makers must think long and hard about what needs to be done if one or more of this trio contracts some injury or the other before/during the ODI World Cup

October 2024. Under Gautam Gambhir's tutelage, India's backroom staff has also embarked on a mission to convert paceman Harshit Rana, 24, into an all-rounder of sorts, relying on his power to eke out bruising late-order runs from the right-hander.

Harshit has a long way to go before being considered an all-rounder in even in the Nitish mould, but these two gems and Hardik are the front-runners to earn slots in the 15-man squad for the next 50-over World Cup, to be played on pace-friendly surfaces (it is believed) in South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia.

Harshit is just coming off an extended lay-off following a severe right knee injury while Nitish is nursing an aggravated left quadriceps injury, the latest in a long and unfortunate list.

Hardik himself sustained a quadriceps injury that kept him out of the Afghanistan ODIs last June and ruled him out of the tour of Ireland and England. Nitish has picked up too many non-cricketing injuries to inspire genuine confidence, while Hardik's shift to Bengaluru to make the most of the expert guidance on various fronts at the Centre of Excellence is both a tribute to his commitment to the cause and an acknowledgement that his body needs constant monitoring and conditioning.

More than worrying about Rohit and Kohli, therefore, the decision-makers must think long and hard about what needs to be done to ensure that the team isn't left hanging at the proverbial last minute should one or more of this threesome contract some injury or the other before/during the World Cup. That is of at least as much importance as repeatedly and frivolously invoking Rohit and Kohli's age, right?

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Illegal foreigners repatriated from Assam

31,789 Of those repatriated, 470 were deported, 29,663 were pushed back, 1,572 were sent back on Union government instructions and 84 were expelled, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma told the State Assembly. PTI

Deceased voters removed from Odisha draft electoral roll

8.32 in lakh. Around 8.32 lakh deceased voters have been removed from Odisha's draft electoral roll during the special intensive revision. It excluded 10.07 lakh shifted or permanently absent voters and about 14,000 entries for which enumeration forms were not received. ANI

Growth in India's steel consumption in Q1 FY27

8.3 in per cent. India's finished steel consumption grew 8.3% year-on-year to 41.6 million tonnes in the April-June quarter of FY27, outpacing production growth of 5.9%, according to the Ministry of Steel. The country remained a net importer of finished steel. ANI

Number of deaths in DR Congo Ebola outbreak

506 The confirmed death toll from the Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo has risen to 506, according to the World Health Organization. The agency said 1,561 confirmed cases have been recorded since the outbreak was declared in mid-May. AFP

Chargesheets filed in Assam police cases since 2016

54 in per cent. Assam Police have filed chargesheets in 54% of the 9.69 lakh cases registered since 2016, the State Assembly was informed. Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said chargesheets were filed in 5.21 lakh cases. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Will El Niño weaken India's economy?

How could a weak monsoon affect farm output, inflation and economic growth? Why does El Niño remain a major risk for India's economy? How have past El Niño years affected agriculture and inflation? Is India's irrigation and water storage system prepared for another weak monsoon?

ECONOMIC NOTES

V. Nivedita

The story so far:

After the first month of this year's monsoon ended in a massive 40% deficit, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast that rainfall in July will also be "below normal" or less than 94% of what is usual for the month. "Below-normal rainfall can pose significant challenges for agriculture, water resources, hydropower generation, ecosystem sustainability, and drinking water availability," the agency warned. The outlook for July comes on the back of weak rainfall in June. This comes weeks after Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan sounded the alarm, warning about the impact of a potential 'super' El Niño.

How could a poor monsoon damage India's economy?

A poor monsoon can damage the economy in three ways: it affects agricultural output, reducing the sector's contribution to the economy; it hits rural income, denting aggregate demand; and it threatens to push up food prices, causing inflation.

India came into this kharif season from a position of strength – foodgrain output in 2024-25 jumped to 357.73 million metric tonnes, up 25.43 MMT from the previous year. A weak monsoon now puts that momentum at risk.

In a report, CRISIL notes that while paddy acreage is expected to expand in Punjab, Haryana and Bihar, maize acreage is expected to decline as farmers shift towards more remunerative crops. Farmers might also prefer pulses because of lower cultivation costs and water requirements, and may choose not to plant vegetables at all. Irrigation, MSP, procurement support and market conditions also factor in the decision-making process.

This could trigger food and beverage inflation. In its June bulletin, the Reserve



Several of India's worst droughts fell in El Niño years — 1972, 1982, 2009, and 2015. FILE PHOTO

Bank of India warned: "An adverse south-west monsoon, if materialised, may weigh on the domestic growth-inflation outlook."

The report noted that daily price data up to June 18 showed food inflation continued to rise and the prices of edible oils, potatoes, onions and tomatoes edged up. A weak monsoon will only push them higher.

Agriculture accounts for only one-fifth of India's Gross Value Added (GVA) but employs 46% of the workforce and supports nearly 55% of the population. "It will have a direct impact on the lives of people," said Prof. R. Ramakumar, School of Development Studies, Tata Institute of Social Sciences.

Prof. Bharat Ramaswami, Department of Economics, Ashoka University, believes farm incomes could fall by up to 10%. "The rural non-farm sector consists mostly of non-traded services such as construction. These sectors contract when agriculture is adversely affected. Industries that depend on rural demand will be affected," he said.

This stress moves into the wider economy. Automobile sales are a reliable early signal; two-wheelers and tractors are among the first sectors to feel the squeeze, followed by real estate in smaller towns and cities. Kotak Mutual Fund, in a blog, has noted that a combined El

Niño-plus-drought scenario may shave 20-65 basis points off GDP growth.

Compounding the pressure are pests and fertilizer supply constraints caused by the Iran war.

The Union Cabinet approved a ₹41,533 crore Nutrient-Based Subsidy for Phosphatic and Potassic fertilisers for the kharif season, covering 28 grades. If output still falls short, the government will have to release buffer stocks and import commodities, widening the Current Account Deficit and putting pressure on the rupee.

India's agri-exports face a threat too. "Agriculture exports have clocked a CAGR of 8.2% between fiscals 2020 and 2025, contributing 12% to India's core exports," said Dipti Deshpande, Principal Economist, CRISIL.

How did El Niño impact the economy?

Several of India's worst droughts fell in El Niño years – 1972, 1982, 2009, and 2015. "In the 11 instances of below-normal or deficient monsoon performance at an all-India level since 2000, six were classified as El Niño years by the IMD. Of these, five saw deficient rainfall," Ms. Deshpande said.

The 2009 and 2015 failures illustrate the different impact poor monsoons can have on the economy. "Two subsequent

years of rainfall stress and all-India average irrigation cover less than 45%, caused agriculture output to suffer – crop GVA contracted 2.5% and 3.2% in fiscals 2009 and 2010, respectively. Inflation was in double digits," she said.

El Niño conditions moved from weak to strong in 2014 and 2015, and both years saw monsoon disruptions. Crop GVA contracted, but the impact on inflation was different.

Unlike 2009, when food inflation spiked, inflation was rather muted in 2015 due to proactive food management, restrained MSP hikes, and a global commodity price slump, which kept inflation muted despite the monsoon failure, Ms. Deshpande noted.

Can India 'drought-proof' the economy?

Mr. Chouhan's presser raised an important data point: 315 districts are vulnerable to a poor monsoon, of which 111 across 12 States are of primary concern due to poor irrigation facilities.

On July 2, storage levels across the 166 reservoirs monitored by the Central Water Commission stood at 47.725 BCM, against 78.077 BCM in the corresponding period last year, and below the normal storage of 48.402 BCM for this time of year. While the system can provide water to meet requirements, a poor monsoon could strain it.

"A second successive bad weather will be more damaging," Prof. Ramaswami said, adding that irrigation is crucial in adapting to water stress due to climate change.

India needs to 'drought-proof' its economy, said Prof. Ramakumar. He said the country must move from crop insurance to ex-ante risk reduction. "We need to pay attention to policies and interventions that reduce risk itself. That requires public investment, and that's lacking," he said. He added that India needs enough drought-resistant, high-yielding crops, and that farmers must have access to them. "We have not invested adequately in any of these, and hence our disaster preparedness is very poor," he said.

THE GIST

A weak monsoon and a potential super El Niño could reduce kharif output, depress rural incomes, fuel food inflation, slow GDP growth, and hurt exports.

Experts say India must move beyond crop insurance by investing in irrigation, drought-resistant high-yielding crops, and other risk-reduction measures, as prolonged rainfall stress could strain water storage and disaster preparedness.

Can Bar Associations refuse to represent an accused?

What has the Supreme Court said about Bar resolutions denying legal representation?

LETTER & SPIRIT

Rizmi Lia M.

The story so far:

The Faizabad Bar Association's resolution to not represent the accused in the Ayodhya Ram Temple embezzlement case has prompted the question of whether a Bar Association could collectively decide not to represent a particular accused.

What is the Supreme Court's take?

The Supreme Court has consistently held that every accused has the right to fair trial and legal representation and it is illegal, unconstitutional and contrary to professional ethics to deny that right.

In a Supreme Court judgment in 2010, *A.S. Mohammed Rafi v. State of Tamil Nadu*, the case arose out of a confrontation between lawyers and police personnel in Coimbatore.

Following the incident, a local Bar Association passed a resolution that none of its members would represent the accused police personnel. A Division Bench of Justices Markandey Katju and Gyan Sudha Misra held that such resolutions by Bar bodies were "wholly illegal, against all traditions and professional ethics".

The court declared in the judgment that "all such resolutions of Bar Associations in India are null and void and the right-minded lawyers should ignore and defy such resolutions if they want democracy and rule of law to be upheld in this country".

What is the accused's right to be defended?

Article 22(1) of the Constitution guarantees that no arrested person shall be denied the right "to consult, and to be defended by, a legal practitioner of his choice". Article 14 provides for equality before the law and equal protection of the

laws within the territory of India.

The Supreme Court has recognised the right to a fair trial as an integral part of the right to life and personal liberty under Article 21.

Article 39A, a Directive Principle of State Policy, further requires the State to ensure that the legal system promotes justice on the basis of equal opportunity and that no citizen is denied access to justice because of economic or other disabilities, including through free legal aid.

What do the Bar Council of India Rules say?

The 'Standards of Professional Conduct and Etiquette' chapter of the Bar Council of India Rules says that "an advocate is bound to accept any brief in the Courts or Tribunals or before any other authorities in or before which he proposes to practise at a fee consistent with his standing at the Bar and the nature of the case. Special circumstances may justify his refusal to

accept a particular brief."

However, the Uttarakhand High Court in *Kuldeep Agarwal v. State Of Uttarakhand And Others* (2019) clarified that "special circumstances mentioned in Clause II, justifying refusal of an advocate to accept a particular brief, refers, by the use of the word "his", to the advocate in his individual capacity, and not to the Bar Association whose members are advocates".

Have such resolutions been passed before?

Yes. Following the 2008 Mumbai terror attacks, a Bar resolution opposed legal representation for arrested terrorist, Ajmal Kasab. The legal aid lawyer initially assigned to him declined to appear, while another advocate who agreed to defend him faced political threats before a lawyer was eventually appointed under police protection.

After the December 16, 2012 Delhi gangrape case, lawyers at the Saket courts passed a similar resolution refusing to represent the accused. Likewise, lawyers declined to defend the accused in the 2019 Hyderabad veterinary doctor's rape and murder case.

How have courts dealt with such resolutions?

The Uttarakhand High Court had in 2019 declared null and void a resolution passed by the Kotdwar Bar Association

threatening to terminate the membership of any lawyer who represented an accused in the murder of an advocate.

In 2020, the Karnataka High Court criticised the Hubballi Bar Association after lawyers objected to advocates representing Kashmiri students accused of raising pro-Pakistan slogans. The Bench described the conduct of lawyers on the Dharwad court premises who prevented advocates from filing bail applications as "sheer militancy". It also indicated that such resolutions could amount to criminal contempt.

More recently, the Madras High Court in *Manikandan Nair v. State of Tamil Nadu* in 2025 reiterated that Bar Associations cannot formally or informally prevent advocates from appearing for any accused.

In the case of *J. Jayalalithaa v. State of Karnataka* (2014), the Supreme Court observed that "fair trial is the main object of criminal procedure and such fairness should not be hampered or threatened in any manner. Fair trial entails the interests of the accused, the victim and the society. Thus, fair trial must be accorded to every accused in the spirit of the right to life and personal liberty and the accused must get a free and fair, just and reasonable trial on the charge imputed in a criminal case".

Thus, the Supreme Court has consistently held that the right to legal representation is a core feature of a fair trial.

A blue and green motorized rickshaw is driving on a wet street during a heavy rain. Two men are seated in the vehicle; the driver is wearing a blue shirt and the passenger is wearing a light-colored shirt. Large blue and white water jugs are strapped to the sides of the rickshaw. In the background, there are trees, a white building with a yellow roof, and other vehicles on the street.

E-rickshaw battery ‘hacks’ and Bluetooth BMS vulnerabilities

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